

Human Development and Communication



Post Graduate Diploma
in
Development Communication

**HUMAN DEVELOPMENT
AND COMMUNICATION****HUMAN DEVELOPMENT AND
COMMUNICATION**

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UNIT 10 FOLK AND TRADITIONAL MEDIA

Structure

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 - 10.3.1 Emergence and Development (World and Indian Level)
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10.0 INTRODUCTION

You have so far learnt about the diverse areas of development communication and the stakeholders involved in them who also play a role in development planning. So while you have begun to appreciate the role of private and public sectors, NGOs and development agencies and grass root level agencies like Panchayati Raj, you would have also realised that development communication cannot bring about the desired change without the potent tool of media. While this block introduces you to different media which are used as vehicles of development, this unit in particular focuses on folk and traditional media.

10.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

At the end of this unit, you will be able to:

- Appreciate the role of folk and traditional media in development communication;
- Describe the different types of folk and traditional media;
- Analyse the social change and community empowerment through participatory methods; and

- Use folk and traditional media in different areas of development communication.

10.2 WHAT IS FOLK AND TRADITIONAL MEDIA?

Folk and traditional media are the oldest tools of development in societies at various levels of progress. The uniqueness of this media is that it involves people's participation to the maximum. The folk media make use of varying combinations of performing arts like village drama, rural dance and folk songs which are unique to a certain community and society. This belongingness to a community gives the folk form a distinct identity of its own. Though the folk art and music of different states of India are distinct, they have some common bearing among them. The names according to the community background keep changing from one community to another. For example, we have "Bihu" dance form in Assam and we have "Kathakali" in Kerala. The culture of a particular community or a geographical region is significantly depicted in its folk forms. This cultural diversity is also a depiction of the Indian diversity.

According to veteran folk media scholar Balwant Gargi "Folk media represents the people in their natural habitat, with all their contradictions and multifarious activities. It gives a glimpse of their style of speech, music, dance, dress and wisdom. It contains a rich store of mythological heroes, medieval romances, chivalric tales, social customs, beliefs, and legends. To understand the colourful diversity and unity of India, it is important to see the folk theatre in its natural settings."

10.3 HISTORICAL IMPORTANCE OF FOLK AND TRADITIONAL MEDIA

Rural India is rich in folk art forms and they have penetrated deep into the social fabric of the villages. This hold on the community's pulse has made it an avid medium of information dissemination, self expression and has also helped in preserving our rich cultural heritage. Every region has its folk and traditional media forms which are immensely popular and relevant to the particular community or population. This has also added to the historical importance of this unique media form.

The following sections would throw light on different aspects of folk and traditional media.

10.3.1 Emergence and Development (World and Indian Level)

The folk and traditional art forms were initially used as a medium for communication in Philippines and London which was formally identified by communication scholars in a UNESCO conference. The modern folk and traditional media evolved from primitive art forms and when humans progressed with time, the art forms also progressed. When we trace the history of folk arts it leads us back to BC 2000 – BC 1000. Indian scholars claim that the folk art forms in the Indian subcontinent are older than BC10000. When the human thought process started to evolve more aesthetically, the use of folk art forms was also found to be used for self expression or satisfying people's feelings.

In the Indian context, the use of folk and traditional media for development communication are widely known and accepted, even though the folk art forms were an integral part of religious message dissemination. Tracing back the history of traditional folk art forms, it was evident that they have been used for communication from the time of their advent but from the 20th century onwards, they became widely used as a tool of communication for development. Not only in India but also many other third world countries they have been used as tools upliftment of a particular community with greater participation. Time and again it has been proved that folk media could play an integral role in social change and its use can bring a sense of intimacy, variety and virility to people. Historically, religious communication or dissemination of rituals was the main content of these folk arts. It was only later that communication scholars could identify the development potential of these media in rural communities. The Indian freedom struggle also made use of songs, ballads, folk plays and a variety of folk forms to inspire people. For example Dr B R Ambedkar's followers Satyashodhak Samaj used Tamasha as a powerful media for social reform. The folk and traditional media have played a great role in the lives of Indians throughout the history of India .

10.3.2 Strength of the Folk and Traditional Media

The strength of this form of media is that wherever it exists, it is the oldest and most loved media for the people. The reach of the folk media is also significant as it has the potential to penetrate deep into the community and the community members identify with them. People's participation in folk forms is another strength as it not only ensures ease of understanding of the content, it also leaves a deep impact on the minds of the community members.

Here are a few specific strengths that these media forms enjoy over the conventional mass media:

- **Community intimacy:** Each community or ethnic group of society has at least some folk and traditional media which they have practiced over generations in their community and are a part of their culture, rituals and ideologies. So it also becomes emotionally connected to the community members.
- **Tool for development communication:** Being close to the community, they are a successful tool to be implemented in all development related communication, activities and campaigns. The folk media makes issue based intervention possible .
- **Credibility:** These media being a part of the socio-cultural fabric of the community, enjoy greater credibility in the eyes of the audiences or community members. The community participation in these media is also high. All these features are missing in the conventional mass media.
- **Regional/Community variations:** All communities are not homogeneous in nature. Different communities have different characteristic features in view of their socio- cultural norms, festivals, ethnicity, etc. The folk and traditional media also keep changing to adapt to the ethos of different communities . Each form of folk art has a certain amount of indigenous content in it which could be hard to relate to for someone outside the

community. Specific community cultural background reflection can provide a strong feeling of togetherness which facilitates the ease of communication to the members of a community.

- **Community participation:** folk and traditional media involve high community participation. People who perform the folk are mostly from the same community. This goes a long way in percolation of communication messages and creates ambassadors of the messages from among the community members. Use of common language or content which the members identify with in real life situations also creates higher chances of acceptability of the community messages.
- **Use of non-verbal language:** Folk media, by its nature, makes use of non verbal or body language. For example, to understand the Kathakali art form, one must understand the ‘Mudras’ because each one of them denotes something. Locally known non-verbal communication techniques may be included in most folk media.
- **Performance-oriented:** most of the folk and traditional media are based on human performance which makes it much more effective for its target audience.

10.3.3 Limitations of Folk and Traditional Media

There are some limitations of this age-old community media. These are discussed below:

- **Limited reach:** the folk and traditional media have limited reach. Though it is a very good media of group communication, it can only reach those who are present at the time of performance to view it. So despite being effective, its reach is limited.
- **Need of an individual approach:** The folk and traditional media cannot be studied individually like other media, for eg. TV or radio. This is because each folk medium’s characteristics are very different from the other folk media which do not allow them to be clubbed together for study or policy making. Each will have to be taken into account individually.
- **Unorganised Workspace:** folk media mostly work in an unorganised setup which is challenging its existence especially when compared to conventional media as a competitor.
- **Lack of advancement:** Societies are seeing a high level of technological advancement in all sectors. But folk and traditional media lack it. Without technology, there is a huge chunk of population which is not reached by folk forms. This may account for its decreasing popularity.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. What is folk and traditional media?

.....

2. What are the strengths and limitations of folk media?

10.4 ROLE OF FOLK AND TRADITIONAL MEDIA IN DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION

Communication is not merely used for transferring information from one person to another, it is used for many other purposes. It is frequently used as a tool to facilitate the people's participation in several developmental activities. Such a form of communication is widely known as development communication. According to American Communication Theorist and Sociologist Everett Rogers, Development communication is the one where communication and its uses are put together for further development. Thus, development communication is an approach used wherein communities are provided with useful information for betterment of their lives. Development communication has two primary roles, 1) Transforming role - where it aids social change in line with the present generations' requirement in a competitive market 2) Socializing role – by trying and maintaining few established values in the current society.

Developing countries comprise 90% of the world's population out of which 70% live in rural villages. This particular rural population is still very far from receiving services like newspapers, internet and the television facilities effectively. In addition to this, high levels of illiteracy hampers the development of approximately 80% of India's rural population. Owing to this, in many parts of rural India, art is still an integral part of the process of living in traditional societies even today. Thus, traditional and folk media play a crucial role in communicating with the people, including various developments and modern messages. They can be effective mass media for preventing the tribal and the illiterates from continuous exploitation, as they do not understand the language of modern communication. Folk forms in India have a marked significance in rural communities. Natives in remote tribal and rural areas of India do not have a facility to access the modern media and hence it does not reach these target groups effectively. In such places, folk forms of communication can find their way and help & contribute immensely in dissemination of the messages otherwise emitted by the electronic media.

Wherever print and electronic media are not accessible, local media is the only form of communication. Such media forms are always contextual and referential. Previous knowledge is often updated and validated through lively art work and

craft. Wisdom, humour and wit are the basic elements of all traditional media forms thereby making it easier and effective to address people and interact with them.. There is content clarity which facilitates learning and understanding due to active and direct communication. Thus the traditional media forms become impact oriented. Traditional media voices the aspirations, dreams, concerns, collective desires, worries, miseries and sufferings of the people thereby acting as a collective pressure forum. It thus empowers people and prompts them to express fearlessly and freely. It also aims at building consciousness on various issues. To summarize, traditional media works in imparting knowledge and information, providing entertainment alongside creating awareness, providing methodology to impart training and then validate, a vehicle of social change, a clarion call to co-exist in civil societies and helps in acceleration of processes leading to betterment.

10.5 DIFFERENT TYPES OF FOLK AND TRADITIONAL MEDIA

Folk media is the language of expression of communities that they are most comfortable voicing their concerns in. At the grass root level, through community participation, it is able to bring out the dominant ideologies of the people. Depending on the different regions of the country, the folk media in India are of various kinds. They can broadly be classified into folk theatre, folk music, folk dance, puppetry, storytelling and sculptures and paintings. In different states, each folk form is differently known and may have different features. Let us know about these traditional folk media briefly.

- 1) **Folk Dance:** Every geographical area has a different folk dance which is the most popular folk form of the respective area and is usually a mix of folk songs and folk tales are narrated through them. It is performed mainly at community get-togethers. For eg. Garba in Gujarat, Manjira and Swang in Haryana, Yakshagana in Karnataka and Ghoomar in Rajasthan are all folk dances of the respective areas.
- 2) **Folk Music:** Folk music is also a popular folk form accompanied by some musical instruments. People usually gather in groups and sing folk songs. The songs are generally reflective of the culture, lifestyle and oral literature of the communities and sometimes they are a satirical comment on the government. For eg. Kajari is the folk music of UP, Bihu of Assam, Babul and Bhatiali of Bengal.
- 3) **Street Theatre:** is a vital folk performance media tool and is an effective tool of communicating socio political messages and speaking loud and clear on issues that common people identify with. They are powerful tools of community mobilization on issues of common interests. Due to its effectiveness, it has also come to the urban areas and is a popular art form among students and theatre lovers. For eg. Nautanki is the folk theatre of UP, MP and Punjab, Pala Jatra of Orissa and Bengal while Bidesia is of Bihar.
- 4) **Puppetry:** Puppetry is a creative portrayal of stories, social issues or any matter that has to be conveyed with some context. Puppetry largely depicts a popular legend, folk tale or story and generally ends with a moral/social

message. They are popular among people of all age groups. There are four main kinds of puppets –

- String puppets – manipulated by strings
- Rod puppets – make use of tall bamboos
- Shadow puppets – these are flat figures illuminated from behind and create shadows that fall on a transparent screen.
- Hand/glove puppets - These make use of a large flat screen with strong light on it and are made by manipulation of palms and fingers.

5. **Storytelling:** It is more theatrical in nature with rhythmic language used for narrating the story. The stories are usually legends or folktales and sometimes also have historic and religious background to them. Colourful costumes and musical instruments add a unique hue to these storytelling performances. At times, it also takes the form of ballad singing.

For eg. Rajasthan has Prithviraj Raso, UP and MP have Alha, Maharashtra has Powada and Tamil Nadu has Villupattu.

6. **Sculpting and Painting:** Sculpting and painting are one of the ancient arts. Others in this category comprise pottery, weaving, metallurgy and textile arts. While the oldest sculptures in the country date back to the Indus Valley civilization, the oldest paintings or drawings are also of the Stone age, the oldest we know of is Bhimbekta in Madhya Pradesh. These were mediums of expression for nomadic tribes and ethnic groups. The subjects of such sculptures and paintings are derived from religion, mythology and nature.

Eg. We have Madhubani paintings in Bihar, Tanjore or Thanjavur paintings in Tamil Nadu, Patta Chitra in Odisha and Warli paintings in Maharashtra.

10.6 SOCIAL CHANGE THROUGH FOLK AND TRADITIONAL MEDIA

10.6.1 Rural Development

Rural Development is often known to be about the process of improving the quality of life and economic well-being of people living in rural areas, often relatively isolated and sparsely populated. Rural development is a comprehensive term which often emphasizes on action for the development of areas apart from the mainstream urban economic system.

India has a rich, vast and varied culture in which modern mass media alone does not constitute all the available communication channels. Due to poverty and illiteracy, thousands of people do not have regular access to such mass media. With 35 percent of the population unlettered and with the media's reach largely restricted to urban areas, information, education & entertainment do not reach a large majority of the people. To them, the mass media proved to be glamorous, impersonal and unbelievable in comparison with the familiar performance of traditional artists whom the villagers could not only see and hear but even touch emotionally. Various forms of folk and traditional media can be utilized to reach different sections of people to bring change and development of the nation. Folk and traditional media have an influence to a great extent on rural society due to

their acceptable idioms, functional significance and entertainment component. Largely folk media can eliminate the difficulty of language, speech, words and certain other barriers of communication like, interest, understanding, interpretation, attitude and perception. Traditional folk media is the most crucial vehicle for social change. While conveying social and agricultural messages a lot of modification may be needed but it is not true in the case of traditional media. Traditional and folk media can easily and efficiently carry social issues related to rural development. Currently, both the traditional and modern forms of media complement each other. There is a need to keep our traditional media alive and active by continuously and cautiously using it while blending it along with the modern media. Documenting traditional and folk media will not only help in preserving and transmitting our culture, tradition and values to the next generation but also help in boosting developmental activities.

The growth of rural activities is not only essential for the citizens living in rural India but is necessary to stimulate the speed of overall economic expansion of the nation.

In the process of the evolution of the nation rural development is pretended to be of noticeable importance in the country today than in the olden days. The process is a strategy trying to achieve improved rural productivity, higher socio-economic equality, and stability in social and economic development.

10.6.2 Community Development

The United Nations defines community development as “a process where community members come together to take collective action and generate solutions to common problems”. It is a broad concept, applied to the practices of various sections of the society to improve various aspects of communities, who typically aim to build stronger and more resilient local communities.

Community development is also understood as a professional discipline, and is defined by the International Association for Community Development as “a practice-based profession and an academic discipline that promotes participative democracy, sustainable development, rights, economic opportunity, equality and social justice, through the organization, education and empowerment of people within their communities, whether these be of locality, identity or interest, in urban and rural settings”.

Community development deals with empowering individuals and groups of people with certain skills required to bring change within their communities. These kinds of skills are mostly created through the formation of social groups which work for a common agenda. Community developers must learn the know-how of the working techniques with individuals.

In reality, community development supports communities, of place and identity, to use their own assets to improve the quality of community life. Also, it helps communities and public agencies to work together to improve services and the way in which decisions are made.

“Community development is fundamentally based on the values of human rights, social justice, equality and respect for diversity”.

According to the National Association of Community Development Extension professionals community development is defined as “a practice-based profession and an academic discipline that promotes participative democracy, sustainable development, rights, equality, economic opportunity and social justice, through the organization, education and empowerment of people within their communities, whether these be of locality, identity or interest, in urban and rural settings”.

10.6.3 Tools for Social Mobilization

Social mobilization is an integrative process where stakeholders are stimulated to become active participants in social change, using diverse strategies to meet shared goals. The process is concerned with mobilizing human and financial resources through five main approaches, namely political mobilization, community mobilization, government mobilization, corporate mobilization and beneficiary mobilization. Partnership building and networking, community participation, media and special events to raise public awareness and advocacy to mobilize resources and effect policy change are some of the key elements of social mobilization. There are several tools for social mobilization but some of the conventional tools for social mobilization are as follows;

- Social networks
- Collaborative working groups
- Newsletter
- Mailing list and SMS
- Blogs
- Petitions and surveys
- Personal impact calculators
- Videos
- Individual stories

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. What are the different types of folk and traditional media?

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2. Explain the tools used for social mobilization in the present times.

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10.6.4 Community Empowerment Through Participatory Methods

Participatory approaches seek a way of empowering a wide range of communities by bringing about awareness, knowledge and understanding, alongside bringing a sense of ownership too which leads to a sustainable change. The catchword in participatory approaches is “participation” - getting community partners in development programmes to take active roles in identified activities, such as decision-making for planning and implementation. Participatory approaches aim to achieve the following:

- 1) Provide local support to various programs, which includes the involvement of local leadership too
- 2) Voluntary generation of ideas and interventions by community members
- 3) Participation in decision making by the disadvantaged groups in the society, particularly women
- 4) Ownership of programs by community members
- 5) Community organizational structures for the management of interventions
- 6) An educational process to generate and sustain participation
- 7) Integration of activities – hardware and software
- 8) Removal of obstacles to collaboration: attitudes, beliefs and behaviors
- 9) The training of local community animators.

The unique difference between participatory and other approaches is that participatory approaches are non-directive in nature. For example, when a participatory approach is applied to sanitation and hygiene behavior change, the following aspects are usually emphasized :

- 1) Providing guidance to community members in making their own decisions
- 2) Helping communities explore and generate self-information for decision making
- 3) Encouraging self-reliance and self-direction, through a sense of shared-ownership
- 4) Nurturing communities to monitor and review their own progress
- 5) Strengthening community resourcefulness
- 6) Allowing the community to decide their pace of activities and respective time frame
- 7) Promoting the concept of learning by doing- Overcoming uncertainty through experience gained and success acquired over time

The success of participatory approaches in community empowerment depends on a wide range of factors. Some of them include advocacy to create an enabling institutional environment, right strategies for program implementation by policy makers, effective tackling of social aspects like gender stereotypes and education background, ensuring proper funds and resource availability, initiating a pilot project to explain how effective could the approach be, realistic time frame to build up capacity to adapt and use the approach etc. It is also important to establish an evaluation and monitoring mechanism to ensure the right direction.

Examples of Participatory Approaches:

Many participatory approaches have evolved over time. They are designed to augment participation through proper and meaningful decision making, monitoring, implementation and evaluation of different activities. These approaches are sensitive to existing situations; they draw answers out of communities, rather than attempting to impose preconceived notions. Few of the examples are mentioned below –

1. PHAST – Participatory Hygiene and Sanitation Transformation

This is an innovative approach to promote hygiene, community management of water and sanitation facilities adapted from the SARAR (refer to point 2) methodology wherein people build their innate ability to address and resolve their own problems. PHAST aims to promote health awareness and thereby empower communities to control sanitation related diseases and improve their water management. This approach is jointly developed by and promoted by UNDP-World bank, UNICEF and WHO.

2. SARAR – Stands for Self-esteem, Associative strengths, Resourcefulness, Action-planning and Responsibility. The PHAST approach is also based on this methodology. It was developed during 1970's and 1980's.

3. Participatory Rural Appraisal - PRA is a process of participation with the villagers in which rapport-building paves the way for them to perform their own analysis and to express themselves whether by means of 'verbals' like narration or 'visuals' such as making a map.

10.7 EDUCATIONAL EXPERIMENTS THROUGH FOLKS

In the previous sections we talked about how folk media is linked with the culture of a community or an ethnic group. Education ultimately is to prepare our children to understand, live in and contribute to their culture: the folk and traditional media can play a crucial role in educating children in such a way that they can relate things with their day to day life. We must expose our children to folk and traditional media which will enrich their knowledge on the culture of their own community or other communities. Basic knowledge of one's cultural background is valuable in itself. While educating our children we are trying to integrate what is learned from the school and what is experienced at home and in communities. There should be space to integrate the community culture with the school curriculum, then only the children can explore the school with greater understanding.

Cultural Shock: When children or individuals experience a cultural set up that provides an exact contrast to their already existing cultural values, they are in for a cultural shock. For example, when a student goes from a village to a metro city for education and finds the freedom that girls enjoy as compared to how they are treated in the villages, he/she is in for a cultural shock. A person is in a state of cultural shock when s/he comes across an environment where the community values, realities, perceptions, beliefs and actions are altogether different and present themselves with a different logic and sanctity as compared to the ones that he was a part of in his/her community.

Often one would wonder that in a diverse set up like that of India with many cultures which folk media should be adopted. The answer to this is that the dominant culture and folk media of the area should be adopted as the communities around would be well versed with them. Let us look at one such educational experiment where traditional media played a worthy role.

‘Kanavu’, meaning ‘dream’ was an initiative of Indian writer and activist, K.J. Baby which was started in 1994 with the aim of educating the marginal communities with the help of folk and traditional media. This alternative school for tribals is located in Nadavayal village of Wayanad district of Kerala. In order to ensure that tribal children do not lose their cultural values, the school which runs with the aid of a Bangalore based charitable trust, incorporated tribal folk forms as the media of education. The education imparted is more practical oriented and helps the children build a sense of their identity and that of their community. The children are trained in folk music and dance, farming and martial arts. An alumni of the school is Ms. Leela Senthosh, the first woman film director from a tribal background who completed her schooling from Kanavu. This school is a unique experiment of use of folk and traditional media in imparting education and making children self-reliant other than carrying out development of marginalized communities.

10.8 REVIVAL PROGRAMS FOR FOLK AND TRADITIONAL MEDIA

Indian is rich with her folk and traditional art forms which enjoy international popularity and are also potent tourist attractions. However, the existence of some of the folk and traditional media is threatened because of factors like it is not a part of urban lives, work complexity, technology and internet which is providing an alternate means of information and entertainment and a modern, busy lifestyle. In this section, we will be looking at how efforts are made to revive or preserve the folk and traditional media.

Several government initiatives have been made for this. Some of them are discussed here:

- **National Cultural Exchange Programme:** This scheme initiated by the government of India aims at supporting artistes and promotion of Indian folk and traditional media through exchange programmes. Seven regions all over India were identified and the artistes of one region were sent to another to perform their art forms. Government bears the expense of conducting the programme and providing remuneration to the artistes.
- **Guru Shishya Parampara Scheme:** This initiative of the Government is aimed at preserving those folk forms which are vanishing or have an existential crisis. The scheme is implemented through zonal cultural centres to nurture young talent in folk art forms. The great master (Guru) and the pupil (Shishya) are provided with some financial assistance as well.
- **Young Talent Artist’s Scheme Award:** Through this initiative, the government encourages young talented artists in the age group of 18-31. The applicant must be talented in certain rare folk and traditional media which are on the verge of extinction.

- **Theatre Rejuvenation Scheme:** this scheme was initiated to support the traditional theatre art forms. Under this scheme seminars and workshops were conducted to promote theatre art including contemporary, experimental, traditional and street theatre.

These are some of the efforts made by the central government. There are also programmes that are run by the state governments at various places. Also there are a few initiatives that are supported by non-profit organisations like:

- **Shrujan:** Shrujan is a NGO working for craftswomen in the Kutch region of Gujarat to uplift women who primarily engage in folk art . They provide a working atmosphere to the rural women and encourage them to live with their indigenous art forms while also earning a living out of it.
- **Anahad:** Anahad is a NGO working to support folk artists who require financial assistance. They identify and support artists who left the folk and traditional media due to the financial crisis and picked up other jobs to fend for themselves.

These are some efforts made by the government or NGOs to uplift our folk and traditional media.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. What is Cultural Shock?

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2. How does participation lead to community empowerment?

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10.9 CASE STUDIES ON FOLK AND TRADITIONAL MEDIA

CASE STUDY 1: Role of Traditional Folk Media in Rural Development: A Case Study of UrmulGaavaniyar (A traditional media group) in the Thar Desert of Rajasthan.

The sands of Thar desert are home to a rich and vibrant tradition of folk art that are based on performance, rhythms, melodies, puppets, colors and a passion of artists who have charmed the desert for thousands of years. These artists not only performed these arts, but also documented them through tales, memories and gave them a hue of the Thar way of life. This idea formed a basis for understanding the cultural heritage of the Thar society. Sudden socio-cultural changes including the new media struck these artists in the 1980's and they were forced to take a call on 'whether to perform' or 'whether to earn a livelihood' from the earlier 'perform and earn a livelihood' form of art. While some of them migrated to cities to work as manual labor, the others who chose to stay slid into poverty and insecurity.

Thus in the 1990's, the URMUL trust, a social organization in the Thar gave birth to Gaavaniyar, a forum where the folk artists could come together and explore possible solutions.

URMUL Gaavaniyar consists of singers, instrumentalists on pungi, dholak etc. and a few puppet players. 'Gaavaniyar' promotes rural development through folk media by performing puppet shows, songs and plays on developmental issues like education, health, migration etc. by moving from village to village, small towns to international forums where the voice of the locals is heard. Moving since then, 'Gaavaniyar' through some skill enhancement got ready to seek sustainable solutions to the problems of the folk artistes and help them earn a livelihood through their art. It is committed to work for the marginalized communities of folk music in Rajasthan.

Gaavaniyar, through its collaborative and diverse approaches, is expanding the platform to create a prototype of income generation through traditional forms of folk expression and eliminating middlemen. Developing greater artistic, management and production skills have made them successful so far. They work parallelly at two levels:

- 1) By performing at various destinations on social causes including health and education, women's right through folk music and puppetry etc.
- 2) Providing services to social organizations for their campaigning

Several other initiatives like developing music albums for commercial distribution, new range of paper mache' products have paved the way for Gaavaniyar to embark on a systematic effort to equip young talent from traditional communities and open up livelihood opportunities for them.

This forum is building consciousness and sensitivity on developmental issues through expressing their views boldly, freely, sternly and fearlessly. Thus, Gaavaniyar is working towards preserving the vibrant and cultural heritage through sustainable and innovative solutions to tackle challenges. This in return, is encouraging a large number of artists to keep their art alive and earn livelihood too.

Case Study 2: Folk Media for Agricultural Extension – A Study of Yakshagana – A South Indian Folk Theatre

Agricultural Extension involves the application of scientific research and innovative knowledge to agricultural practices primarily through farmer education. Thus, agricultural extension becomes an important prerequisite of

agricultural development in developing countries like India as it aims to transfer information from the global knowledge base and the local research to the farmers, educating them to make better decisions and stimulating desirable agricultural development. Several folk media including Yakshagana play a significant role in agricultural extension communication from the perspective of diffusion of innovation. Diffusion of innovation studies the process of awareness and acceptance of a new process or technique in a community up to the grass root level.

Yakshagana is a 500 year old south Indian folk theatre, popular in the coastal districts of Karnataka. Yakshagana has its base in epics like Ramayana, Mahabharata, Bhagavad Gita and various other puranas which are rich in noble values. Every Prasanga (episode; play text in the form of poetry) based on these mythologies have a deep impact on their audience, thereby influencing generations of natives with its morality and ethics. Yakshagana has been a channel of informal education for the masses, aptly referred to as an Open University as the locals have developed a psychological bond with the art and artists.

The history of Yakshagana influencing locals with regard to agriculture dates back to the early independence days in India. The outbreak of the second world war(1939-45) and the Great Bengal Famine of 1943 which killed millions of people due to starvation put severe strain on India's food economy. The situation compelled the government of India to initiate the 'Grow More Food' campaign in 1948. Agricultural departments of all the state governments were given the responsibility of implementing this campaign. Yakshagana played a significant role in disseminating the objectives of this campaign and other schemes of agricultural development in Karnataka's coastal regions in the 1950's and 60's. Competitions were also held so that Yakshagana authors could come up with new prasangas (episodes) dealing with agricultural development. Several prasangas on agricultural development were composed and performed during this period which included NelluraGella (literally means 'victory of village of Paddy, 1958), Japani Krishni Vijaya(victory of Japanese Farming Technique,1959), Rashtra Vijaya (Victory of the Nation, 1961), Krishi Vijaya (victory of agriculture,1960) etc.

Effects of Modern Agriculture and Yakshagana

Yakshagana has not only looked at the positive side, but also looked at the other side of modernization of agriculture. The artists have responded to the contemporary developments in the field of agriculture and composed prasangam highlighting the ill effects of over-mechanization. Two prasangas in this regard were Savayava Vijaya (meaning victory of organic farming,2010) and Krishni Vijaya (though with the same title of 1950's and 60's, this one highlighted the demerits of acceleration of food production and promoted the need for organic farming).

Many authors and artists have argued that Yakshagana should not be restricted to just entertainment. Any art that does not accept contemporary influences will be more dead than alive. Yakshagana has made the maximum use of its flexibility and responded to contemporary issues. All the prasangas above have a single broad intention of agricultural extension. Yakshagana is a traditional folk theatre that does not cause changes all of a sudden because it works at a deeper psychological level. But overall, Yakshagana prasanga can create a congenial environment which is an important prerequisite of agricultural extension.

Case Study 3: Role of Folk Media in Rural Development: A Study of Combating Child Marriage in Malda

The custom of marrying daughters early is a prevalent and widespread practice in the financially backward, illiterate poor villages of rural Bengal as in many other states of India as well. Among many other rural districts of Bengal, Malda is reported to have the highest incidences of child marriages in the state (5-6% higher than the state average). Economic necessities, ensuring male guardianship, avoiding sexual assault etc. are a few reasons among others for these early marriages. Child marriage is an absolute violation of human rights and child abuse. Thus, this case study explores a combating mechanism of this social curse in Malda through awareness using folk media of the district.

Surveys in the form of questionnaires and personal interviews were conducted in 30 villages (two in each of the 15 blocks of Malda) to understand the causative factors and formulate an awareness campaign. Folk media forms like the Gambhira and Domini were chosen as a communication tool for the awareness generation programmes which required training workshops for these artists, interactive theatre shows, meetings with adolescent girls etc.

Theatre based awareness campaign was one among many other awareness campaigns including Workshops with adolescent girls, Community meetings, Stakeholder Consultation etc. There were two components to the Theatre based awareness campaign

- 1) Capacity Building- wherein workshops were conducted for the local theatre groups of Gambhira and Domini for sensitizing them on the issues of child rights and child marriages and thereby guided them to develop theatre script on these themes. The Domini and Gambhira groups aimed at sensitizing the villagers on:
 - Early marriage and problems associated with it
 - Child rights and laws
 - Legal age of marriage (18 for girls and 21 for boys)
 - Severe health impact on the girl due to an early marriage
 - Skill development for girls
 - Contact details of agencies working for prevention of child marriages
- 2) Street Theatre Shows were held in market places, near temples, Masjids etc. Exhibitions were put up depicting the ill effects of child marriage which were followed by audience interactions where villagers would be asked questions out of the messages disseminated.

After these performances, it was observed that the villagers had high acceptance of the messages conveyed through dramas like Gambhira and Domini reflecting the high potential of these art forms to drive developmental messages to rural villagers. Also, various schools and local police stations were seen to mobilize their resources on composition of folk songs and dramas to create awareness among people.

Thus, communication is an important tool to promote cultural and social development of a Nation and the role of folk media cannot be overlooked in it. To overcome this curse of child marriage, folk media should be used to educate the illiterate, ignorant superstitious sentiments of the rural people along with focusing on interpersonal communication skills to mobilize and sensitize people to participate voluntarily and end child marriages in India.

10.10 LET US SUM UP

Folk and Traditional media are the most unique communication media that have the effectiveness that the conventional media cannot have. It is participatory in nature and so does not appear to be an intrusion in the community. Also, of late some successful educational experiments have been made with folk media. Overall, it is in a position to serve all the functions that the mainstream media do – educating, informing, making people aware and persuading the people to make the desired behavioural change.

The traditional folk media are also strategic tools of communication aiming at bringing about development in a community on issues of common interest. They are not only able modes of communication, they are also the strong symbols of a community's culture and ethnicity which is being preserved as our heritage not only on a national level but also through international organizations like UNESCO and others.

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10.12 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress: 1

1. Folk and traditional media are the oldest tools of development in societies at various levels of progress. The uniqueness of this media is that it involves people's participation to the maximum. The folk media make use of varying combinations of performing arts like village dramwa, rural dance and folk songs which are unique to a certain community and society. This belongingness to a community gives the folk form a distinct identity of its own. Though the folk art and music of different states of India are distinct, they have some common bearing among them.
2. Refer to 10.3.2 and 10.3.3

Check Your Progress: 2

1. Refer to 10.5
2. Refer to 10.6.3

Check Your Progress: 3

1. Refer to 10.7
2. Refer to 10.6.4

UNIT 11 PRINT

Structure

- 11.0 Introduction
- 11.1 Learning Outcomes
- 11.2 Mass Communication- Definition
- 11.3 Mass Media and Society
- 11.4 Broad Media Policy Framework
 - 11.4.1 Freedom of Expression
 - 11.4.2 Concern about Nation Building and Development
 - 11.4.3 Commerce and Entertainment
- 11.5 Press
 - 11.5.1 Pre-independence Press
 - 11.5.2 Press during Freedom Struggle
 - 11.5.3 Press in Independent India
 - 11.5.4 Mission to Profession
 - 11.5.5 Emergency Period: A Dark Chapter
 - 11.5.6 Present Era
 - 11.5.7 Contemporary Challenges
 - 11.5.8 Ever Expanding Press, Books
- 11.6 Let Us Sum Up
- 11.7 References and Further Readings
- 11.8 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

11.0 INTRODUCTION

In the previous unit you have learnt about the history of mass communication. In this unit you will be learning about development of print media in India. You know well that media influences both politics and economics of a society. As such, knowledge of media scene will help you to have a better understanding of the contemporary India.

Newspapers, magazines, books, comics etc. are the main print media you all are well familiar with. All these are important in today's world as they continue to reflect and mould the priorities of the society despite the availability of new media. In this unit, we will learn the brief history, growth and the factors affecting the operation of print media in the contemporary Indian society.

11.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

At the end of this unit you will be able to:

- describe the features of mass communication media;
- explain the role of mass media in society;
- explain the broad policy framework of print media;
- describe the history and evolution of print media; and

- explain the challenges faced by contemporary print media.

11.2 MASS COMMUNICATION-DEFINITION

We may define mass communication as a process whereby mass-produced messages are transmitted to large number of people, spread over and not at one place, heterogeneous and anonymous masses of receivers. By heterogeneous we mean people who are different from each other on account of age, gender, education, income, profession, residence, location, region, language, religion and so on and so forth. By anonymous we mean that the individuals receiving the messages are generally strangers to one another and also to the sources of those messages. The messages have been sent “to whom it may concern”. Be that as it may, to make mass communication more effective, segmentation of mass audience is done keeping with various considerations to make mass communication more focused and targeted.

11.3 MASS MEDIA AND SOCIETY

Mass Media play an important role in our day to day life. To know the cricket score you watch television, listen to radio or check your mobile updates. To know what have been the major developments in the country and the world you read newspaper or go to news websites. For entertainment you watch films, play games on mobiles or computers, read novels, books and magazines or watch television. Newspaper, magazine, books, radio, television, and film are mass media. We all are familiar with these mass media and are exposed to these mass media on a daily basis.

So, what do the mass media do in society? They give us scores and running commentary on our favorite games as they are played, inform us about the environment in which we live in the form of news and commentary about political developments, trouble spots, major events, accidents etc. Through mass media we come to know about the floods in Jammu and Kashmir, cyclone in Odisha or Indo-US nuclear deal. 24x7 television news channels bring news as news breaks and follow the news story as it unfolds and develops. The mass media track inflation and report economic developments. They analyse for us the current events. They sell goods and services.

The mass media set our agenda of work and leisure time activities. The contents of mass media are discussed in homes, coffee shops and at the workplaces. In the process the media keep us informed about the environment we live in. They influence our perceptions about various issues and personalities and shape public opinion and help in democratic functioning of our society. The mass media makes us laugh, cry, create drama, bring music and entertainment. In short, through mass media we communicate with the masses and sustain mass society.

Today, it is difficult to imagine normal social life without the newspaper in the morning, mobile phone or TV. In our day to day existence, media and society are intimately linked and are interdependent realities of modern life. As such, in order to understand contemporary India, we need to understand contemporary media scene in India.

11.4 BOARD MEDIA POLICY FRAMEWORK

The importance of print media was realised during the course of freedom struggle itself. As such, after Independence broad policy framework guided the development, growth and use of print media. These include:

11.4.1 Freedom of Expression

As India opted for parliamentary democracy based on universal adult franchise, freedom of press was considered an essential element of democracy in the country. Although, the Indian Constitution has no express provision which specifically provides for freedom of the Press as such, however, the **“Right to Freedom of Speech and Expression”** provided under the Article 19(1) (a) of the Constitution as part of our Fundamental Rights and have been interpreted to include freedom to publish newspapers without any governmental interference subject to only reasonable restrictions that have been provided Article 19 (2). Only such restrictions can be imposed as are reasonable and are in the interest of sovereignty and integrity of India. Later in 1990s this interpretation was extended to air waves also to include electronic media. Free exchange of ideas and free debate are considered as essential part of the democratic functioning of government. *(You will be learning in detail about ‘Freedom of Press’ under Press Laws in another unit.)*

11.4.2 Concern about Nation Building and Development

Along with providing for “Freedom of Expression” the leadership in free India was concerned about making use of mass media and all other means of public education for promoting the unity and integrity of the nascent nation state and informing, educating and mobilising the people and seeking their willing participation in political and social development of the country. Like mixed economy approach towards national development, in information and broadcasting sectors also a mixed approach was adopted. While the press was free and largely in private hands except the requirement of registration of titles, foreign news agencies like Reuter, AFP etc were restricted and could provide their services to Indian news agencies like Press Trust of India (PTI) and United News of India (UNI). Broadcasting and telecommunication were retained as central government monopoly. Film production again was in private hands but public exhibition of films was subject to certification / clearance by the representative of the central government.

In India this concern about reaching people, communicating with them and equipping them with new skills was emphasised in the First Five Year Plan itself which provided the blue print for country’s planned development. It said: “A widespread understanding of the priorities which govern the Plan will enable each person to relate his or her role to the larger purpose of the nation as a whole. All available methods of communication have to be developed and the people approached through the written and spoken word no less than through radio, film, song and drama. Above all, steps have to be taken to provide literature and information for the people in simple language and on scale equal to the need of the country”. Such a broad policy framework guided the development and growth of media in India till 1991 when a major policy shift took place leading to liberalisation and globalisation and ushering in the Information Technology revolution in the country. As a result, mass media scene dramatically changed with exponential growth and diversity.

Today, the mass media in India is free and is largely in private hands. Any citizen can bring out a newspaper or a magazine and publish what he/she chooses without obtaining any prior permission from any authority subject only to the responsibility before the law of the land for what he/she would choose to publish. To publish a newspaper or a magazine the only requirements under the Press and Registration of Books Act of 1867 are registration certificate and declaration and printing legibly on it the name of the printer, the place of printing, the name of publisher and the place of publication.

But in case of Radio, Television and telecommunication the Central Government had the monopoly until 1991 when the Freedom of Expression, the Fundamental Right given in the Constitution, was interpreted by the Supreme Court of India to extend it to airwaves as well. With liberalisation and globalisation in 1990s the electronic media and telecommunication were also opened to private sector. As a consequence, today mobile phone is a common sight and we have many private TV channels and FM radio stations as well. It may be noted that though we have many TV news channels, still broadcasting of news on radio continues to be the monopoly of the central government.

11.4.3 Commerce and Entertainment

Commerce and entertainment are the other two important features of mass media. Besides providing information and education, the mass media are the major sources of entertainment. To attract and retain their audience, the mass media have to provide even information and education in an interesting and entertaining manner. Moreover, to recover the cost of production and distribution and make some profit, the mass media have to depend upon revenue generated through advertisement. The advertisement revenue depends upon readership, listenership and viewership of newspaper, radio and TV. As such, although providing information, education and entertainment are the primary functions of mass media, the promotion of commercial interests through advertising and marketing are becoming the major driving force in media operations. At times 'quality' and 'contents' are sacrificed in favour of advertisement revenue. Often sensationalisation of news and events is also resorted to increase circulation and TRPs to promote commercial interests. As a result, the mass media have increasingly become major infotainment business industries.

Realising that mass media play important role in our day to day life and 'freedom of expression as provided in the Constitution of India as the basic value that propels and guides media operations, we will now discuss in detail the growth and development of different mass media so as to have a better understanding of contemporary India.

Activity 1

- 1) How much time did you spent yesterday in reading newspaper, listening to radio and watching TV?
- 2) Write the date and the day of the week
- 3) Name of the Newspaper
- 4) Time spent reading the newspaper (in minutes)
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Check Your Progress 1

Print

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

- 1) What are the provisions in the Indian Constitution with regard to Freedom of Press?

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Internet

Name of the Website	Time spent (in minutes)
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- | | |
|------------|------------|
| i) | i) |
| ii) | ii) |
| iii) | iii) |

TV

Name of the Channels	Time spent on Watching (in minutes)
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- | | |
|------------|------------|
| i) | i) |
| ii) | ii) |
| iii) | iii) |

11.5 PRESS

11.5.1 Pre-Independence Press

The Beginning: The Press has had its fair share of trials and tribulations in its evolution in India. The first weekly print venture '*Bengal Gazette*' was started by James Augustus Hickey on 29 January 1780. His newspaper primarily published slanderous news against the East India Company, especially the Governor-General, Warren Hastings in the garb of freedom of expression. Soon some more newspapers began to be published in Calcutta, Madras and Bombay. In Madras the first newspaper, *Madras Courier* appeared in 1785 and four years later Bombay's first newspaper, *Bombay Herald* was published.

As these newspapers largely catered to British residents and reported about activities of the East India Company, their circulation was small. Press laws did not exist and publishers were not free to print news as per their discretion. There were some innovations such as letter to the editors, advertisements as well as reporting on fashion and social issues.

11.5.2 Press during Freedom Struggle

The first half of the nineteenth century was characterised by proliferation of newspapers, especially in Indian languages. These papers put up a resistance against strict and unfair government regulations.

Many Indian elites also became editors and publishers in different parts of the country. Their circulation was still in thousands only still these newspapers became vehicles of social reforms, information, contacts and social awakening. It was believed that keeping an eye on the language newspapers could have revealed about the rebellion and appropriate measures could have been taken.

Raja Rammohan Roy, the social reformer, journalist and freedom fighter from Bengal started the Calcutta Journal and followed it up with Sambad Kaumudi and Mirat-ul-Akhbar. The first Hindi language newspaper, *Uddant Martand* was published by Pt. Jugal Kishore Sukool on a weekly basis in the year 1826. Printing presses were sealed, newsprint was seized and many editors were jailed. The period after the first struggle for independence called for tighter regulations for the Indian language press.

There was significant expansion in the nationalist press near the end of the 19th century. The Marathi weekly *Kesari* and English weekly *Mahratta* were brought out by Bal Gangadhar Tilak in 1880.

Tilak was not just a nationalist but also a true social reformer. He stressed that newspapers should expose social conditions that need to be improved. For him, the newspaper was also a means of political emancipation.

Mathur (2013) wrote that the anger and unrest against the British was at its peak in the early part of the 20th century. The powerful writings by Mahatma Gandhi also influenced the public. *Young India* and *Harijan* were able to amass huge readership and become vehicles of freedom struggle. He wrote with conviction and passion. His writings were simple, clear and powerful. Gandhi Ji published the newspapers to arouse feelings for 'Swaraj' as well as offer a platform to express the feelings of the people.

Gandhi Ji is known as a prolific journalist who could sway public opinion through his writings. This can be understood easily by the fact that even though his newspapers did not accept advertisements, they could survive through subscriptions. They became instruments for spreading his ideas amongst the public. His stand on the national movement was very well represented through his writings. Therefore, his newspapers garnered good readership.

Many popular leaders of the time took a cue from Gandhi Ji and took up journalism as a means to reach out to the people. They joined the fray as editors and publishers. With their missionary zeal, they used their weeklies or dailies for social reform, education and national awakening. The journalism of this era was known for its missionary zeal towards the cause of Indian independence (Mathur, 2013).

In the hands of Gandhi, Nehru, Tilak and many others, these newspapers became instruments of freedom struggle against the British rule in India.

11.5.3 Press in Independent India

An all pervasive euphoria prevailed after Independence marking the end of foreign rule after a long and arduous freedom struggle. The press was no exception. There was great enthusiasm to express national urges and aspirations, and to build a strong independent India. The press was part of, and at the same time, vehicle of such urges and aspirations. The press was supposed to play a part in

nation building and support the development efforts by the government. In fact, such was the importance placed on the press, that it came to be called as the fourth estate- the first three being the Legislature, Executive and the Judiciary.

The first Prime Minister, Jawahar Lal Nehru, also contributed a lot towards development of the press. He pressed for a free and fair press. He had famously remarked that, “I would rather have a completely free Press, with all dangers involved in the wrong use of that freedom than a suppressed or regulated Press”. As a result, the Press was significantly deregulated after India gained independence.

Thus, the Press in India is free, vibrant and vigilant. It fearlessly exposes the wrongs in our society and polity. It zealously guards its own freedom and brooks no restrictions or regulations from the government.

The Indian press is largely in private hands and is commercial enterprise from the days of its pioneers. Numerically individual ownership accounts for majority of the newspaper titles but their circulation is limited. On the other hand, small number of companies (about 75) own major daily newspapers with multi editions and magazine accounting for over 80 per cent of the circulation.

11.5.4 Mission to Profession

Indian independence brought along changes in the role of the press. Earlier, they were connecting popular leaders to the public by acting as a ‘views-paper’ and helped them in gaining support for their initiatives. It became a powerful instrument of freedom struggle. This changed after independence as the reverence for leaders gave way to a more watchful attitude about their decisions. Although the popularity of the leaders continued unabated as they had formed a bond with the masses during the course of the struggle, the press quickly adopted the role of a watchdog.

However, government felt a need to regulate the newspaper industry post independence. Therefore, First Press Commission of India was constituted in 1952 to help newspapers maintain their independence, raise the standards through a code of conduct and maintain high professional standards as well as high standards of public taste. On the basis of their recommendations, the Press Council Act, 1965 was passed and the Press Council of India was established in 1966.

Gradually, strict regulations for press resulted into the new trend of ‘hand-out’ journalism where reportage was restricted to official version of events handed out for publication. There wasn’t much scope for critical analysis of the actions of the government even as political rivals received newspaper coverage. Nehru paid attention to the critical editorials and cartoons even when they were critical of him. However, the press was refrained from publishing any major expose during his time with the exception of the Indo-China war in 1962.

The press bitterly criticized Nehru’s defense preparedness and Krishna Menon, the then Defense Minister, became the first major victim of the press attack in free India (Mathur, 2013).

11.5.5 Emergency Period: A Dark Chapter

In subsequent years, things changed rather drastically. The press was not as kind to Indira Gandhi, who dominated the Indian political scene for nearly 18 years,

as it was to Nehru. She viewed the press with guile and suspicion. Such a mutual distrust led to the press taking up the adversary role vigorously and the rulers using both carrot and sticks to tame the press failing that imposed national emergency and censorship on the press in 1975 which lasted for about one and a half year. That the “journalists crawled when they were merely asked to bend” is a sad commentary on the profession as a whole during emergency days. With the end of emergency and lifting of censorship in 1977 gave boost to growth of the press in India, especially the news magazines. As a result, the Second press commission was constituted in 1978 that stressed upon building cordial relations among government and the press.

Exposing the failures of the Government and those in public life is an age-old and well recognised function of the press. It is true of the Indian press as well. However, with the exposure of the Bhagalpur blinding case in Sunday, the English weekly in 1979 resulting in the public uproar, began a new phase in Indian journalism. Some public-spirited lawyers took up the case with the Supreme Court giving a new turn to the watchdog function of the press. Since then the investigative journalism in India has covered many milestones and in the process many misdeeds of individuals and the governments have come to the public light.

As a consequence, the conflict between libertarian philosophy and social responsibility theory of the press, which together guided and molded the functioning of the press in India over the years, is now becoming sharper. There is no denying the fact that journalism as a profession has come of age in India. From being a mission, it has graduated into being a competitive and market-driven industry. Promotion and hard selling have become necessary. Skills and strategies of selling news and newspapers have become essential. Catchy headlines, attractive layout are necessary for sale and promotion some time even at the cost the ‘contents’ the main substance of the press - the news.

In 1980s and 1990s the revolution in communication technologies and opening of Indian economy with liberalisation and globalisation transformed the press in India rapidly. Computerisation, enormously improved telecommunication services, satellite, mobile phones, latest printing technologies, digital cameras all contributed to introduction of colour and the rapid expansion of the press in the country. Simultaneously, the perception about press changed. Press came to be viewed as an industry and a business and the newspaper as a product to be marketed and sold just as any other product like soaps and toothpastes. The proprietors of many a newspapers and magazines started giving preference to advertisers and marketers over the editors and news reporters. The institution of the editor declined.

Be that as it may, newspaper is more than a product to be marketed and sold to consumers. It affects minds, thoughts, values and culture of the readers. So, it is much more than being a product though economic viability of newspaper is essential and profit making is also legitimate as it is a commercial activity.

11.5.6 Present Era

This was also a period of rapid technological advancements helping in first hand news gathering from distant places including remote areas with speed or simply downloading from the internet services, transmitting, editing, colour printing

and delivering the final product- to the readers all over the country. The result is multi- editions of major newspapers, special supplements, segmentations and zoning giving rise to regional and district news editions.

The increased capacity to handle large amount of news daily made it possible for newspapers to take upon some of the features of magazine journalism as well. Consequently, some of the news magazines were closed down like, The Illustrated Weekly of India, Dharumyug, Sunday etc; while many special interest magazines like Business India, Business World and Business Today; film magazines like, Filmfare, Stardust, Cine Blitz; computer and technology magazines like Computers Today and Telematics; became more popular. To meet the growing interest in economic developments and the market, most daily newspapers both English and other Indian languages, added special business sections. Not only that the number of exclusive business and economic dailies increased and became popular.

The coming of many 24x7 television news channels posed some threats to newspaper industry but soon it adjusted to new environment. Television news channels may have become the prime sources of hot spot news and breaking of news stories, the newspapers continue to be the providers of the details of the news stories and analysis. The newspapers started giving more features and soft news stories and photo features and what is popularly known as Page-3 journalism came into vogue. It would not be wrong to say that television news is like the appetizer and newspapers are like the main menus for satisfying the hunger to know as to what is happening daily in the world around us.

11.5.7 Contemporary Challenges

Today, the press is accused of indulging in paid news which means publishing paid features or news articles in exchange for money. These are different from advertisements since they look like normal news features. This is an ethical violation as readers may not be able to differentiate between news and paid news. Other key issues the press faces today are violation of the Majithia wage board recommendations on salaries of working journalists, poor ethical standards and spreading yellow journalism or sensational stories. However, not all changes are bad. New experiments have added colour and made newspapers more interesting. The newspaper apps and e-papers have allowed people to access online editions of newspapers from their cities despite being thousands of kilometers away.

The improved presentation styles, better use of colours, pictures, design and graphics due to rapid growth of digital media, fast and convenient editing through computers and content customisation have made it a very dynamic industry.

However, commercial considerations have at times taken precedence over professional propriety leading to sensationalisation of news presentations and commentary to boost the sales, bringing a bad name to the noble profession of keeping the public informed about the environment in which we live and damages the credibility of the fourth pillar of democracy. To check such tendencies self regulation by the press itself is preferred to any outside interference from outside.

The designated body to do this is the Editors Guild of India.

11.5.8 Ever Expanding Press, Books

Thus, notwithstanding the growth of television, the press continues to expand and grow in India. In 1950s only 240 daily newspapers were published in India. This number rose to 2,856 dailies in 1990 and to 5364 daily newspapers in 2000. In March 2018, there were more than a lakh publications registered with the RNI.

In 1993, the total number of newspapers and periodicals published was 35,595 which has gone up to 62,550 in 2006 which indicative of substantial growth of the press since 1990s. As per the 55th annual report of Registrar of Newspapers of India, we have a total of 82,237 registered periodicals of which 32,793 were in Hindi. English came second with 11,478 newspapers and periodicals. The total circulation of newspapers increased to 32,92,04,841 from 30,88,16,563 copies in 2009-10.

The publication of books in India dates back to 1566 when first printing press was established in Goa. Today, publishing books is a flourishing business. Advances in marketing and technology have propelled India's book publishing industry forward into a rapid and glorious expansion. Today, books are available in local translations, in electronic forms as e-books, in audio form as audio books and in picture form as graphic books. Nielsen Book Scan estimated that 13 million books worth Rs 3.28bn were sold in the year 2011 covering over 286,455 separate titles. In the end of the year 2013, magazine industry was valued at INR14 billion. Niche magazines targeting a specific audience like magazines on photography, travel, lifestyle, Bollywood, architecture, sports, business etc. are performing the best.

Activity 2

Find out the latest

Circulation figure for the Press as whole

Circulation figure for the English daily Newspapers

Circulation figure for the Hind dailies

Circulation figure for the dailies in other Indian languages

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. What was the role played by press in pre independence period?

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2. How did Gandhiji define the objectives of press?

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3. Mention some famous social and political figures who also worked as journalists in pre-independence period along with names of their publications.

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4. What were the main responsibilities of the press in post independence era?

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5. How have technological changes impacted the press?

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6. What are the problems faced by the press in today's time?

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11.6 LET US SUM UP

Mass Media in India have played an important role in the development of our country as informers, educators and entertainers. Each media has contributed in its own way towards development of the nation at different times. The print media was the first major medium that reached the masses apart from folk media. Thus, print media (books, newspapers, magazines, journals etc.) has a long and important history. It was primarily centered around organising masses against the British and played a key role in mobilising support for the national independence movement. In early days, British citizens started publishing the newspapers to vent their anger against the government. Later, the freedom fighters

used them to connect with masses, organise revolts, remove superstition and unite the nation.

The British had to place restrictions on the growth of the press as it became a threat to them. Many freedom fighters including Mahatma Gandhi brought out their own papers. The constitutional provisions about Freedom of Speech and Expression helped the newspapers immensely in newly independent India. The newspapers at the time focused on nation building and assisting the government to bring about development. They went to the extent of openly and fearlessly criticising the actions and policies of the government. A Press Council was constituted to safeguard the interests of the press.

In the 1970's, the imposition of emergency by Mrs. Indira Gandhi, the then Prime Minister, caused irreparable loss of reputation and quality to the press. In some cases, censorship was imposed and papers had to get prior approvals for publishing stories. Things started improving with the coming of liberalisation in 1990's. Newsprint was subsidised and companies from outside were allowed to invest in the Indian printing world. Cable TV gave stiff competition to newspapers as sources of news and as a result, the quality of news presentation improved.

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11.8 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

The Indian Constitution has no express provision for freedom of the Press, however, there is **“Right to Freedom of Speech and Expression”** provided

under the Article 19(1) (a) as part of our Fundamental Rights. It has been interpreted to include freedom to publish newspapers without any governmental interference subject to reasonable restrictions provided in Article 19. Check Your Progress.

Check Your Progress 2

1. During its early days, the press in India was managed by British. They used it to publish about their dissatisfaction with the government. Later many freedom fighters and social reformers used the press for nationalist causes. It was a vehicle of social and economic reform, political emancipation. It was also an instrument for national unification.
2. According to Gandhiji the main objectives of the press were:-
 - to understand the popular feelings and give expression
 - to arouse among people certain desirable sentiments, and
 - to fearlessly expose defects in public life
3. The personalities are
 - Raja Rammohan Roy - *Sambad Kaumudi* and *Mirat-ul-Akhbar*,
 - Bal Gangadhar Tilak - *Kesari* (Marathi) and *Mahratta* (English)
 - Mahatma Gandhi - *Young India* and *Harijan*
4. Immediately after independence, there was great enthusiasm to express national urges and aspirations, and to build a strong independent India. The press was part of, and at the same time, vehicle of such urges and aspirations. The press was supposed to play a part in nation building and support the development efforts by the government. It was also expected to perform the role of a watchdog.
5. Computerisation, improved telecommunication services, satellite, mobile phones, latest printing technologies, digital cameras all contributed to introduction of colour and the rapid expansion of the press in the country. Press came to be viewed as an industry and a business and the newspaper as a product to be marketed and sold just as any other product like soaps and toothpastes. The proprietors of many a newspapers and magazines started giving preference to advertisers and marketers

UNIT 12 RADIO

Structure

- 12.0 Introduction
- 12.1 Learning Outcomes
- 12.2 History of Radio
 - 12.2.1 International Perspective
 - 12.2.2 National Perspective
- 12.3 Radio in Colonial time
 - 12.3.1 Amateur Radio
 - 12.3.2 State Involvement
- 12.4 Radio after Independence
 - 12.4.1 Post Colonial Period
 - 12.4.2 Time of Free Airwaves
- 12.5 Looking at the Future
- 12.6 Let Us Sum Up
- 12.7 References and Further Readings
- 12.8 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

12.0 INTRODUCTION

In the previous units you have been introduced to the growth and development of media. In fact if you introspect you will understand that history of media's growth is the history of the development of technology. Therefore we see that all media rediscover themselves according to the demand and the necessity of time.

In this unit we will trace out the growth and development of Radio in the Indian and International perspective. It will be interesting to unite the refinement of technology in the journey of radio's development.

12.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

Apprise you the historical development of Radio as a technology as well as media. After studying this Unit, you should be able to:

- describe the historiography of Radio;
- explain the philosophy that defined Radio in India; and
- analyse the political economy of its growth in India.

12.2 HISTORY OF RADIO

12.2.1 International Perspective

Radio as a means of communication achieved prominence during the World War II. It was used in military activities to communicate from one base to the other and carried orders and commands. The technological development of radio was

regarded as a revolutionary discovery of the modern world. In 1887 German Scientist, Heinrich Rudolf Hertz demonstrated that electromagnetic waves can be transmitted through space and his name got attached to denote the unit of radio frequencies. Italian engineer Guglielmo Marconi received the first trans-Atlantic wireless signal from England to Newfoundland in 1901. In the US in 1910 inventor Lee de Forest conducted live radio broadcast from the Metropolitan Opera House in New York and it is regarded as the landmark wireless voice and music transmission. These random developments in various levels added to the growth of Radio as the medium of the masses.

In the West the development of radio as the medium of dissemination of information was taken seriously. In fact with the development of commercial broadcasting, public service broadcasting was also taken up by the state quite sincerely. The history of public service broadcasting is generally traced to British Broadcasting Corporation of England. The thrust of public service broadcasting is still very much relevant in the Third World countries. But in some countries, it has been relegated to being the mouth piece of the state rather than the public.

With the UN project of Information and Communication Technology for Development (ICT4D), radio has gained immense importance in the modern globalised world. However it is important that radio adapt to the new and challenging conditions.

12.2.1 National Perspective

Radio came to India during the British rule in the guise of an amateur experiment. In 1920 the Bombay Presidency Radio Club was established by express support of Giachand Motwane. He is also credited with the honour of being the first one to record and broadcast radio programme in India. It is noteworthy that just a few months before the Radio Club in Bombay, British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC) was given the go ahead to launch a public service programming across Britain by the British government in January 1927. The state involvement started later and when India got independence the baton of Radio was passed from one government to the other. The 1990s saw new development and a lot of hopes were pinned on to the medium. However a critical review now makes the picture hazy. In the next section we will try to give a comprehensive idea about the growth trajectory in detail.

12.3 RADIO IN COLONIAL TIME

12.3.1 Amateur Radio

As mentioned above Radio in India was an amateurish experiment. The venture of Motwane which had the call sign of 2KC lasted for only one day. Next year in a joint venture between the newspaper 'Times of India' and Post and Telegraph office another station was launched in Bombay (now Mumbai), the signals of which were received 100 miles away in Pune. The third station by the call sign of 2FV with the power of 750 kHz and a 1.5 kW transmitter was started in Bombay after two years. Bombay had a fourth station when Walter Rogers Company started one with the call sign of 2AX. It was more of an Adventist church venture.

On the Eastern region, in Calcutta (now Kolkata), the Marconi Company of England conducted a number of test broadcast in various locations. Eventually

Calcutta Radio Club loaned a transmitter from Marconi Company and started their radio station in November 1923 with the call sign of 2BZ. The West Bengal government too loaned a transmitter from Marconi Company and launched a station with the call sign of 5AF.

Similar activities could be seen in Madras (now Chennai) during the same period. The Madras Presidency Radio Club under the call sign of 2GR started operating in 1924 with Viscount Goshan, Governor of Madras as patron. This station closed down in 1927 due to financial constraints and the transmitter was donated to the Corporation of Madras, who operated with the international call sign of VUM.

There were two other stations – one in Madras and one in Bangalore. The station in Madras was operated by the Crompton Electric Company. Both the stations were operating in 1926. There was also a 1 watt station which was established by a postal official at his home in Hyderabad in 1933.

12.3.2 State Involvement

State involvement in broadcasting began when Government of India signed a contract with a private company named Indian Broadcasting Company (IBC) Ltd. in 1927 allowing them to begin experimental broadcasting in Bombay and Calcutta simultaneously. It is mentionable here that this was the same time that following the publication of the Crawford Report (2 March, 1926) British Broadcasting Corporation was launched (1 January, 1927), which was supposed to be non-commercial and crown-chartered. In fact by 1926, it was already being discussed in the Government about formalising the system and structures of broadcasting. It is said that the rules of the Radio Clubs were brought to a forced end as IBC thought that the sale of radio licence could earn them handsome revenue. In fact Fielden had written in his book *Broadcasting in India*, how the most successful of India's Radio Clubs, the Madras Presidency Radio Club, was finally forced to close down in October 1927. However setting up of the first operational transmitters in Bombay and Calcutta took one year and considerable cost was incurred. Even the company was also underfinanced with only 42,000 pound. To make things worse, the company could not sell as many licences as they had thought they would: only 3,594 were issued by the end on 1927. India's geographical reality also came in the way. It was vast and had no electricity.

Thus the company started to feel increasingly that the realities of Britain were not to be found in India. BBC which was operating on the same commercial monopoly agreement between 1922 and 1926 was expanding rapidly in Britain. However IBC by 1930 had opened only two small transmitters and had issued less than 8,000 licences. Moreover programmes were also mostly in English. In fact Secretary of State, Lord Birkenhead had written to Lord Irwin in a personal letter that IBC should make programme for "English Speaking Population, that is to say Europeans and the educated Indians of the cities", totally ignoring the masses. Thus in spite of government support, IBC turned out to be a financial failure. Ultimately in 1930, IBC went into liquidation and was forced to shut shop before the completion of the fourth year.

However if you look at the broadcasting activities in India before 1930, it will be obvious that a lot of speculative business was taking place in the area, for example, shipping of radio sets, transmitters etc. These people along with the programmers and the public put pressure on the government and government yielded and took

over the Bombay and the Madras stations in April 1930. Government of India decided to purchase the assets of IBC and those were placed under the control of the Department of Industry and Labour. 1930 was also the time of 'Civil Disobedience Movement' and the government could see the potential of the newly redesignated Indian State Broadcasting Services (ISBS) being utilised in the consolidation of the Indian state as well as of political unity. The post war great depression also had an effect on the financial condition of the government of India. This financial difficulties and the lack of real enthusiasm on the part of the government to continue with broadcasting led to the closure of IBC on October 1931.

The rumour in Britain was that the radio stations of Bombay and Calcutta might be sold to American commercial interest. The Federation of British Industry was visibly worried and they lobbied in the India Office against the sell-off. Representations and agitations compelled the government to go back on the orders on November 23, 1931; doubling the cess on the radio sets. In 1932 the British Broadcasting Corporation started an Empire Service and it resulted in the doubling of the sale of the receiving sets in less than two years. All these sets were imported at that time. The increase in the collection of license fees and import duty on the sets and components of the radio sets also resulted in the increase of government's revenue. However it should be remembered that though the number of listeners increased, it still remained confined to the elite. This picture of financial viability of broadcasting culminated in the government's decision to start a radio station in Delhi. Delhi station went on air on January 1, 1936.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. What are call signs?

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2. Name five radio clubs in India.

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3. Explain what are IBC and ISBS?

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This development was very important as Radio began to be used as an indispensable medium of propaganda and this was directed at two enemies of the Empire: the nascent Congress led independence movement and the alliance specifically Germany. It is well documented in the directive issued by the Empire Intelligence Service (1940) how radio was linked to intelligence gathering: “we need our intelligence organisation on the spot, with headquarters in Bombay, controlled and administered by a specially chosen Indian...It is clear that the co-operation of All India Radio would be essential but there is every reason to suppose that it would be cheerfully forthcoming. The organisation would also be able to produce a skeleton service of information about Burma”.

The first Director General of BBC, John Reith, who is acknowledged as the father of Public Service Broadcasting, was expressing his interest in Indian Broadcasting. He wrote to the Viceroy, Willingdon on the issue of state level broadcasting in India. Willingdon was quite interested in the idea and in 1934 he wrote back to Reith that he should help Willingdon to find someone to work on a five year contract. Reith had written in his autobiography, *Into the Wind*, how he himself had mulled the idea of taking up the assignment only to be negated by the higher authorities. The man selected from BBC was Lionel Fielding, to shape up AIR the lines of BBC. Fielding therefore was not quite happy with the use of broadcasting for intelligence activities. But Reith and Fielding's vision to build up broadcasting in India in the line of BBC remained a distant dream. It was made clear to Reith that AIR will not be modelled in the self governing style of BBC rather it will remain with the Industries and Labour Department as it already was since 1930.

Fielding was not happy with the name ISBS, he wanted a name which would have an all-India personality. He coerced the Viceroy Linlithgow into adopting the name All India Radio (AIR) in 1936. Fielden recruited the help of devoted young people and with their help and his Chief Engineer, Goyder, he started short-wave transmission in 1938 and gave AIR a wider coverage. Lucknow station was started on April 2, 1938 and Madras station on June 16, same year. In 1939 the Trichur station went on air and in the same year the external services also started. Fielden went on medical leave in 1939 and returned briefly only to permanently leave Indian soil by 1940.

This was also a time when other hand people like Frank Lugard Brayne, (a civil servant in the Gurgaon district) and few others advocated the usage of radio for the uplift of the rural community. This resulted in the establishment of rural radio stations (somewhat similar to the concept of community radio now) in places like the rural outskirts of the Northern cities of Lahore, Delhi and Peshawar, in Southern Madras, Midnapore district of Bengal and princely state of Hyderabad. These stations were eventually incorporated into the All India Radio network after 1937.

Another very interesting development was taking place during this period. Indian Nationalist movement was at its peak and the nationalist groups started exploring the issue of ‘illegal’ counter broadcasting. From 1940 onwards there have been evidences of amateur radio operators setting up pro-Congress stations like the Azad Hind Radio etc. This radio station started operating on 26th August 1st 1942 after the arrest of Mahatma Gandhi when All India Congress Committee decided to demand British to Quit India. The station was broadcasting on 41.78 meters. As it was a secret radio it had to be shifted many times to escape detection.

Historian Gautam Chatterjee says, “According to the old records, Vitthal Rao Patvardhan brought a broadcasting equipment of the Congress Radio (which Madhav Limaye called Azad Radio) to Nasik. It was kept in Sankaracharya Math from where the *Azad Radio* went on air. But perhaps fearing police raid, the transmission equipment was immersed in the Godavari River.”

“At those dark hours of new black-out, the Congress Radio went on air and worked as an inspiration for the masses. It spread the message of secularism, internationalism, brotherhood and freedom,” he says.

“Ram Manohar Lohia and Vithaldas Madhavji Khakar were given the responsibility to organize broadcasting messages and programmes during the movement, he says. Khakar was the chief organiser of the Congress Radio Enterprises and was answerable to Lohia,” he says.

Two amateur radio broadcasters ‘Bob’ Tanna and Nariman Abarbad Printer played a key role in setting up Congress radio. Owen Williamson says:

Despite sporadic British jamming, the crystal-controlled signal of Congress radio was audible on then-unoccupied 40-metre band throughout the Indian subcontinent, and as far away as Japanese-occupied Burma. The station transmitted recordings of the Mahatma’s sermons and calls for non violence, uncensored news, pro- independence, instructions for Gandhian activists, and political declaration by the movements’ underground leadership....(‘The Mahatma’s Hams’, [http:// www.wr6wr.com/newsSite/articles/features/mahatmashams.html](http://www.wr6wr.com/newsSite/articles/features/mahatmashams.html)).

The first Indian administrator of AIR was A. S. Bokhari, who was groomed by Fielden. He was the Director General during all the war years and all during the independence movement and the partition too. A new broadcasting house was built on the Parliament Street, New Delhi. On June 3, 1947, Lord Mountbatten (the then Viceroy), Jawaharlal Nehru and Mohd. Ali Jinnah gave their historical speeches through AIR.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. Write short notes on:

a) John Reith

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1. Lionel Fielding

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2. Write about the phenomenon of pirate radio during the independence movement.

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12.4 RADIO AFTER INDEPENDENCE

When the British left India, it was a divided India. Thus India was left with only six Stations at Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Lucknow and Tiruchirapalli with 18 transmitters (six on the Medium Wave or MW and the rest on Short Wave or SW). The coverage area was 2.5% and 11% of the population. Radio listening on MW was confined to urban areas.

The importance of the role of communication for national development was underscored in India even prior to her independence. The Indian National Congress while formulating policies for National Development for Independent India set up a Sub-committee on Communication under the National Planning Committee to offer recommendations for development of communication for independent India. The report of the National Planning committee cited the following as the target of broadcasting for independent India: “(a) Dissemination of news and useful information; (b) Adult education; fighting rural ignorance; (c) of the country in 1947, the new Indian government announced a development-ori) Propaganda by the State and (d) Entertainment” (NPC: section 13). After independence entered agenda of governance dedicated to the amelioration of the economic, educational, and health conditions of the people.

With the target of Development Communication, the new government adopted the recommendations of the erstwhile National Planning Committee as the mainstay of its communication policies. P C Joshi in his book *Communication and National Development* had written: “The issue of using modern communication acquired high priority as a developmental resource during the Nehru era when the planners explored the prospects of using radio as a development agent, that is, for information and enlightening the people in the countryside and towns on developmental issue”.

It is to be noted here that the post independence growth plan was charted by the Tatas and Birlas by drafting the Bombay Plan also called *A Plan for Economic Development of India*. It was drafted by J.R.D. Tata and G.D. Birla and was extensively discussed in the Birla-owned journal called the *Eastern Economist*. This plan had supported private enterprise and protectionist politics in support of indigenous capital. However the state remained the nodal agency in the area of economic growth. In 1955 was adopted the Industrial Policy Statement in the Avadi session of the Congress government. In this policy, basic and strategic industries, including heavy industrial plants etc. were all reserved for development in public sector. Similarly in the Industrial Policy resolution of 1956, telecommunication, broadcasting and defence equipment was also reserved for the public sector.

12.4.1 Post Colonial Period

In the First Five Year plan, no financial allotment was done for the broadcasting sector neither any mention was made on it. But investment to the tune of 4.94 crores was done and by 1956, most of the region was covered by AIR. Second Five Year plan envisaged wider coverage and for the first time plan document spoke about setting up a television station with an allocation of 40 lakh. Of the entire plan allocation of 9 crores the maximum amount i.e. 267.81 lakh was earmarked for studio installation and additional office accommodation. Hence the focus was on infrastructure development. And this trend continued.

However the growth had not been as fast. By 1960 56% of the population and 37% of the country's area was covered by medium wave services. Therefore the majority of the area was left to short wave coverage which was not clear. In fact Mehra Masani in her book *Broadcasting and the People* writes that even in 1984 a reliable medium-wave service could reach only 90% of the population and 75% of the geographical area. Which according to her means that radio was accessible to 20% of the population which was mainly in the urban area.

We need to remember that during that time the system of collecting licence fee was in force. A person with a radio set was required to deposit a fee amount at the local post office to ensure continuing reception of signals. This is what we do now to keep receiving the television signals in our sets through the Digital TV set box. And it is still in vogue in UK as far as BBC is concerned. BBC has been able to retain its autonomy largely because of the licence fees that they collect, thus they do not depend on the government fund for sustenance. This system of collecting licence fee was eventually abolished in the 1970s.

After 1968 the annual rate of increase in licences has fallen steadily and the numbers of household with radio sets were only about 25 million. Even the production of sets witnessed a slow decline. Radio sets were more in demand than could be supplied during the period of 1960-70. But the demand declined after that. But this was the time when Green Revolution in India was in full swing and AIR had been a close companion of the revolution. It was naturally expected that the demand will increase for the sets. But it did not happen as expected. In spite of the slowdown in the listeners' base the setting up of stations and transmitters went on. As Masani had noted most of the transmitters were set up as a part of political necessities.

It is mentionable here that, in 1962 India fought a war with China in the North-Eastern front. This war revealed the inadequacy of the reception of radio signals in the border areas. As a follow up the government constituted a committee on broadcasting and Information media, popularly known as the Chanda Committee, on the 14th of December, 1964. The committee reviewed the operation of various media units under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. It submitted a report on Radio and Television on 18 April 1966.

The committee felt that it was not possible in the Indian context for a creative medium like broadcasting to flourish under the regimentation of departmental rules and regulations. Therefore it recommended the constitution of a separate corporation for radio and television. The report also suggested that both of them be given freedom to evolve their own recruitment rules, pay and service condition according to their varied and peculiar necessities. Another recommendation was

for the starting of a commercial service. And it was started from Vividh Bharati in 1967.

However, In April 1970, the Lok Sabha was informed by the government that it was not the opportune time to consider the conversion of AIR into an autonomous corporation. But, a major structural change was accepted i.e. to separate Radio and Television and Doordarshan came into existence on April 1, 1976 under the I&B Ministry.

Soon after the internal emergency, a white paper on the misuse of the mass media during the emergency was presented to the parliament in August 1977. In the elections, the opposition parties presented freedom of expression including autonomy to electronic media as a major election plank.

After the new Janata Party government took charge, the working group on Autonomy for AIR and DD was constituted by the Ministry of I&B by a gazette notification dated August 17, 1977, under the Chairmanship of B. G. Verghese with 11 members.

Important amongst the major recommendations was that of setting up of an independent public corporation acting impartially, as Trustee in the public interest referred to as Akash Bharati in the tune of National Broadcasting Trust. The Working committee did not want two separate corporations for Akashvani and Doordarshan, but suggested a highly decentralised four-tier broadcasting organisation at central, zonal, regional and local levels.

India hosted the Asian Games in 1982 and television which was till then at a nascent stage received a major boost. In 1984, Rajiv Gandhi became the Prime Minister of India and he was very keen on the medium. The entire political focus shifted to the new medium. The popularity of AIR also declined. There was a general apathy in the government to rejuvenate the medium.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. India has a very strong population which is underdeveloped; we cannot have radio for profit.

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12.4.2 Time of Free Airwaves

1990s was a very critical period for India both politically and economically. India was suffering from internal political instability and the fragile National Front coalition faced a nationwide crisis in the summer of 1990 over its affirmative action policies. By autumn, a campaign by the BJP to build a Hindu temple at the

site of a 16th century mosque in Ayodhya resulted in widespread communal violence. The government collapsed when the BJP pulled out. A new minority government failed to pass the scheduled budget in February 1991 when it lost the Congress Party's external support. In May 1991, while campaigning for the general elections, Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi was assassinated. In reaction, and in parallel to these developments, the economic situation worsened. By September 1990, net inflows of Non-Resident Indian deposits had turned negative. Access to commercial borrowing had become more costly, and by December even short-term credit was restricted.

Foreign exchange reserves fell to \$1.2 billion in January 1991. By the time a new government took over in June, reserves could cover only two weeks of imports. India was close to defaulting on its sovereign debt for the first time in its history. And thus India negotiated a \$1.8 billion loan from IMF (International Monetary Fund) with conditions. The condition applied by IMF resulted in the Structural Adjustment Programme (SAP) which pre-empted the involvement of the state in state expenditures in many welfare sectors including health and education. Neoliberalism had entered India with full force.

PRASAR BHARATI:

Prasar Bharati Broadcasting Corporation of India (BCI) Act was enacted with the objective to confer autonomy on Akashvani and Doordarshan, thereby ensuring that they function in a fair, objective and creative manner. The Prasar Bharati Act provided a direction and pointer, which should govern the broadcasting policies.

In fact, the demand for autonomy for AIR and TV dates back to mid-sixties, when the first ever expert committee (the Chanda Committee) went into the issue.

The Prasar Bharati Bill of 1989 is largely based on the Verghese Report (1978) and the Prasar Bharati Bill (1979) that was introduced by the Janata regime in Parliament in May, 1979. While the Prasar Bharati Bill favors the creation of a broadcasting corporation through an act of Parliament. The Verghese Report clearly wanted broadcasting autonomy to be a part of the Indian Constitution. This would be necessary to ensure that no future government would tamper with the freedom and independence of the corporation. The bill manages to sneak in a representative of MIB as a part time governor. This is not the 'full autonomy' the Verghese Committee had in mind. The bill of 1979 became an Act in 1990 with approval by all political parties in the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha.

The first step the ruling Congress Government took in response to the 'invasion' by cross-border satellite television was to set up the Varadam Committee (1991) to re-examine the Prasar Bharati Act of 1990. The Ram Vilas Paswan Committee was set up for this purpose in 1995. It submitted a 104 page working paper with 46 recommendations on public and private electronic media, newspapers, news agencies and films. The committee had hammered out consensus on National Media Policy. Some of the recommendations were incorporated in the Broadcasting Bill introduced in Parliament in May, 1997. The Nitish Sengupta Committee (1996) was constituted in 1996 to have another look at the Prasar Bharati Act and to suggest amendments. It submitted its report in August of the same year.

The Prasar Bharati Bill remains a dead letter with the successive governments never being serious about autonomy for the official electronic media. The government is more interested in revenue but without proper service condition or focused programme presentation earning revenue can only remain a dream and Prasar Bharati a mirage.

This was also the time when the Supreme Court of India gave a ruling declaring airwaves as public property which came in 1995. This translated into the radio sector being opened up to private players. Now a handful of big business houses, with non media and media interests have dominated the FM radio market. The then Finance Minister P. Chidambaram had announced the licensing of 295 more radio stations in 2013-14. It is interesting to note that private FM channels are mainly urban centric and plays 24X7 film songs. News is not allowed to be broadcast yet.

Another offshoot of this order of the Supreme Court was the opening up of the airwaves for Community Radio. Several non-governmental organisations and media-activist groups campaigned for nearly a decade for the right to set up local radio broadcasting facilities to support their community development work. They also networked to further the cause of community radio in the country. This network, soon after the announcement of the community radio policy, came together in January 2007 to constitute the Community Radio Forum (CRF) of India. CRF has espoused the mandate to support and promote the setting up of community radio stations in India and to lobby for policy changes that would amplify the progressive nature of the community radio policy and further simplify and democratize the licensing procedures.

The Bangalore-based communication campaign group, 'VOICES' convened a gathering of radio broadcasters, policy planners, media professionals and not-for-profit associations in September 1996 to study how community radio could be relevant to India, and to deliberate on policies appropriate for such an action. A Declaration calling for the establishment of community broadcasting was signed. A suggestion that AIR's local stations should allocate regular airtime for community broadcasting was put forward. Requests were also made for grant of licences to NGOs and other non-profit making groups for running community radio stations. Subsequently, UNESCO made available a portable production and transmission "briefcase radio station" kit to VOICES to do experimental broadcasts of programmes for a hands-on learning experience towards the objective of setting up an independently-run community radio station.

A UNESCO sponsored workshop, hosted by an Andhra Pradesh NGO, Deccan Development Society (DDS) from July 17-20, 2000 in Hyderabad issued the 'Pastapur Initiative' on community radio that urged the government to take its intentions of freeing broadcasting from state monopoly to its logical conclusion, by making media space available not only to private players but also to communities. This landmark document urged the government to create a three-tier structure of broadcasting in India by adding non-profit community radio to the already existing state-owned public radio and private commercial radio.

The spirited campaigning for communities' right to access the airwaves and innumerable representations by organisations, academicians and individuals resulted in the MIB organising a workshop supported by the UNDP and UNESCO in May 2004 in New Delhi to design an enabling framework for community

radio in India. The workshop brought together a large number of community radio enthusiasts, academics, NGOs and policy makers, who worked out a set of recommendations for a new community radio policy, one that would allow community groups to run their own radio stations. When the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) issued a consultation paper later that year, they arrived at largely the same formulations for community radio.

In July 2004 MIB prepared a draft policy based on the May consultations. Subsequently, community radio groups in India launched an online petition campaign, urging the inclusion of the right of communities within the community radio policy and thereby ending the discrimination against rural and poor communities. In October 2005, the draft policy was referred to a group of ministers, who took about a year to give its approval after deliberating upon several contentious issues such as advertising, news and information, licence fee, and spectrum availability.

These intense advocacy efforts and passionate debates about community radio broadcasting for the social sector finally capitulated into an inclusive community radio policy approved by the Union Cabinet in November 2006.

As of 2012 there are 125 functioning Community Radio Stations in India. Of these 125 stations more than 90 are Campus Radio station located either in the campus of educational institute or Krishi Vigyan Kendras.

By the end of March 2018, there were 238 functioning community radio stations in India. Out of these, 135 were campus radio stations located in educational institutes, Krishi Vigyan Kendras and State Agricultural Universities.

The post 90s time has seen a very interesting trajectory. The most important feature of this time as far as media is concerned is the growing presence of the private sector in media, where state's role has been diminished to being an 'enabler'. Even the state media apparatuses, Doordarshan and AIR have been following the revenue model of the private media houses.

Check Your Progress 4

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. News is not allowed to be broadcast in Private FM Channels as well as in Community Radio. Do you think it is justified? Explain.

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12.5 LOOKING AT THE FUTURE

The future of radio in India seems to be a bit hazy. While state owned AIR seem to have lost the way in the dense forest of governmental apathy, the only flourishing arm of radio seems to be the private FM channels. Community Radio

is yet to find a grip in the country with governmental control making it quite tough to survive.

With rapid digitisation and internet access the next gen is getting more and more hooked to satellite radio. But the role of AIR and Community Radio cannot be brushed off in a country like India. A serious political will is necessary to catapult the medium from the fake inertia that it is suffering from at present.

12.6 LET US SUM UP

We hope that by now you have understood the way radio had grown in India. From an amateurish attempt to the governmental project it had seen numerous ups and downs. Post independence when our first Prime Minister visualised radio as a medium of propaganda, he also simultaneously opined that radio is the medium which was important for dissemination of information to the poor masses. But with the growing politicisation of radio, it has been left as a state propaganda mechanism of the ruling party. On the other hand the space for private radio has been opened up unbridled albeit without the independence of broadcasting news. Thus radio has survived and will survive as India remains a class divided country.

12.7 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READINGS

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12.8 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

See 12.3.1, 12.3.2

Check Your Progress 2

See 12.3.2

Check Your Progress 3

See 12.4.1

Check Your Progress 4

See 12.4.2

UNIT 13 TV

Structure

- 13.0 Introduction
- 13.1 Learning Outcomes
- 13.2 History of Television
 - 13.2.1 International Perspective
 - 13.2.2 National Perspective
- 13.3 Television in India
 - 13.3.1 Television for Development
 - 13.3.2 Site to Asian Games
- 13.4 Television after Gulf War
 - 13.4.1 Star and Zee Television
 - 13.4.2 24x7 News
 - 13.4.3 Regional Television
- 13.5 Looking at the Future
- 13.6 Let Us Sum Up
- 13.7 References and Further Readings
- 13.8 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

13.0 INTRODUCTION

In the previous units of this block you have been given extensive information about the origin of Mass Communication. You have also by now understood how the trajectory of print, and radio had shaped in the country. You also have marked an interesting development in print i.e. the growth of the language press. You must have also understood the uniqueness of this growth, which has a mixed legacy of colonial heritage and independence struggle.

In this unit we will discuss with you the growth of the most intriguing of all media, i.e. television. How from a neglected child of the Indian government it turned out to be the blue eyed boy. We will also understand the phenomenon of 24 hours television channel and how it has percolated down to the growth of regional television channel. This journey will also be interesting and you will definitely find answers to many question that you had been asking yourself about television.

13.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

This Unit will help you learn in depth knowledge of the growth and development of television nationally and internationally. After studying this unit, you should be able to:

- describe the historiography of Television;
- explain the philosophy that defined Television in India; and
- analyse the political economy of the growth of TV in India.

13.2 HISTORY OF TELEVISION

13.2.1 International Perspective

The first successful demonstration of television was in San Francisco on Sept. 7, 1927. This system was designed by Philo Taylor Farnsworth, a 21-year-old inventor whereas Boris Rosing in Russia had conducted some crude experiments in transmitting images 16 years before Farnsworth's successful experiment. There were other sporadic experiments too in other parts for example, John Logie Baird in England and Charles Francis Jenkins in the United States in the 1920s. However, Farnsworth's invention, which scanned images with a beam of electrons, can be regarded as the direct ancestor of modern television. The first image he transmitted on it was a simple line. Soon he aimed his primitive camera at a dollar sign to answer an investor's queries, "When are we going to see some dollars in this thing, Farnsworth?"

EARLY DEVELOPMENT

In USA RCA, the company that dominated the radio business in the country invested \$50 million in the development of electronic television. In 1939, RCA televised the opening of the New York World's Fair, which also made President Franklin Delano Roosevelt, the first president to appear on television.

World War II slowed the development of television, as companies like RCA turned their attention to military production. Full-scale commercial television broadcasting in USA began in the United States only in 1947.

In 1947 the House Committee on Un-American Activities began an investigation of the film industry, and Senator Joseph R. McCarthy claimed that there was a visible Communist infiltration in broadcasting too. Political beliefs suddenly became grounds for getting fired. Most of the producers, writers, and actors who were accused of having had left-wing leanings found themselves blacklisted, unable to get work. CBS even instituted a loyalty oath for its employees. Among the few individuals in television well positioned enough and brave enough to take a stand against McCarthyism was the distinguished former radio reporter Edward R. Murrow. In 1954 the U.S. Senate censured McCarthy, and CBS's "security" office was closed down.

Between 1953 and 1955, television programming began to take some steps away from radio formats. The programming that dominated the two major networks in the mid-1950s borrowed heavily from another medium: theater.

In 1964 color broadcasting began on prime-time television. The FCC initially approved a CBS color system, then swung in RCA's favor after Sarnoff swamped the marketplace with black-and-white sets compatible with RCA color (the CBS color system was not compatible with black-and-white sets and would have required the purchase of new sets).

PUBLIC BROADCASTING

A Carnegie Commission report in 1967 recommended the creation of a fourth, non-commercial, public television network built around the educational nonprofit stations already in operation throughout the United States (see television, non-commercial). Congress created the Public Broadcasting System that year. Unlike

commercial networks, which are centered in New York and Los Angeles, PBS's key stations, many of which produce programs that are shown throughout the network, are spread across the country. PBS comprises more than 300 stations, more than any commercial network. PBS funds come from three major sources: congressional appropriations, viewer donations, and private corporate underwriters.

INTERNATIONAL GROWTH

Growth of Television in development followed different patterns in other countries. Often government, not private corporations, was the owner. In Great Britain the British Broadcasting Corporation, the country's dominant radio broadcaster, established and retained dominance over television. The BBC, funded by tax on the sale of television sets, established a worldwide reputation for producing quality programming. The Canadian Broadcasting Corporation also functioned independent of government support albeit due to commercial pressures, however maintained the seriousness of much of its news and public-affairs programming. France's major television networks enjoyed government patronage; however, there was protest in France that it led to the tilt in news coverage toward the ruling party. By the late 1980s and 1990s, as cable and direct-satellite television systems increased the number of channels, the hold of these government-funded networks began to weaken. Most countries around the world began moving more toward the U.S. model of privately owned, advertiser-supported television networks.

13.2.2 National Perspective

Now that you have been apprised of the international scenario of the growth and development of Television, let us come to the national perspective. India resisted television for a long time. But it got a boost during the 1980s. From the 90s Indian Television history spanned out in an entirely different way. As per the Information and Broadcasting Ministry website till 6th March 2012 the number of television channels beaming into and out of India are 831.

We will now discuss the multifarious nature of growth of this challenging media.

13.3 TELEVISION IN INDIA

As mentioned in Unit 8, the National Planning Committee convened by the Indian National Congress set up a sub-committee on Communication to offer recommendations for development of communication for independent India. After independence of the country in 1947, the new Indian government adopted Development Communications as the mainstay of communication policies. But it is interesting to note that Nehru resisted Television. In fact many call it ironical as Nehru was quite well read, aware of developments elsewhere and admired the Soviet Union, where the use of newspapers and films for state goals had received great attention and patronage from the government.

Before Chanda Committee, no review of the broadcasting policies was done in India. The committee was formed in 1964 under the chairmanship of Asok K. Chanda, and was called the Committee on Broadcasting and Information Media. The Committee report strongly reflected the development imperatives that governed the philosophy of broadcasting in the sixties and the seventies. It blamed

insufficient allocation of resources for the development of the mass media for the “inadequate information, poor motivation and insufficient participation by the masses in the country’s development programme”. It may be mentioned here that the committee was mainly looking at the status of radio, as television was still confined to Delhi; however the report of the committee did look futuristically at the growth of television too.

Though Nehru was hesitant about introducing television in India, but scientists like Vikram Sarabhai argued that television should be given special priority for accelerating national development. He believed in the power of technology in taking forward the national agenda for implementing schemes of economic and social development. This was of particular significance for population living in isolated rural countries.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. Who is generally credited as the father of television and why?

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2. When did the world’s first colour broad cast happen? Write briefly.

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3. Which country began the first television service? Write in detail.

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4. Do you think Nehru’s views on TV have been proved right? Explain briefly.

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13.3.1 Television for Development

In September 1959, the experimental television services of All India Radio began as part of a UNESCO pilot project. The transmitter for the broadcast had been sold at a nominal cost by Philips India Ltd., a multinational electronics company which had exhibited closed-circuit television technology at an industrial fair in Delhi in 1955. UNESCO donated 45 television sets to teleclubs in secondary schools too. In early 1961, UNESCO funded another experiment in the effectiveness of social education. In 1961 Ford Foundation too joined the bandwagon and sponsored school programmes for four years. This project also included exchange training for programme personnel between US and India. In fact in 1961 this experimental service had become a regular service but remained confined to Delhi.

Sarabhai motivated Indira Gandhi to support an indigenous satellite development programme after she became the prime minister in 1966. He proposed India's first experiment with farm television in 1967 and was the first to champion the idea of using direct broadcast television to reach the most difficult and least developed areas of the country first, rather than the urban population.

The second station was commissioned after a gap of thirteen years in 1972 in Bombay (now Mumbai). However it is interesting that after Bombay the next two stations were established in Amritsar and Srinagar in 1973. By then India had already fought two wars with Pakistan and the people in Amritsar had access to Pakistan TV beaming across the border. So when these two transmitters were set up those also could beam onto parts of Pakistan. The Government also sent around 250 television receivers into villages in the Kashmir Valley. The Transmission hours of the Srinagar station was increased phenomenally to counter the propaganda by Pakistan Television which was received very clearly in the valley, and naturally attracted much attention. After that, in 1975 the next phase of commissioning of stations spread television to Calcutta, Madras and Lucknow.

13.3.2 SITE to Asian Games

The Satellite Instructional Television Experiment (SITE) was an experiment which was also a brainchild of Vikram Sarabhai. However Sarabhai died in 1971 before the project could take off. But he had already groomed a group of young energetic scientists who saw to it that the experiment was a success. According to Bela Mody, "SITE was conceived in the mid 1960s when mass media was considered powerful agents of development and satellites were becoming available to carry the development message to otherwise unreachable areas".

SITE was provided a telecommunications satellite on loan by NASA to broadcast for one year during 1975-76. This project was developed in close cooperation with the United Nations, which helped to set up the Experimental Satellite Communication Earth Station in Ahmedabad. In return, India provided training facilities for representatives from developing countries. It started beaming development oriented programmes to 2400 Indian Villages, and the software was designed according to the socio cultural specificities of the targeted population.

SITE was also important because of it getting support from some important personalities. Most prominent of them was the influential ISRO scientist, Vikram

Sarabhai. He was very vocal about the necessity of using television to 'leap-frog' India into sustained economic growth and development. Sarabhai was also instrumental in setting up ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation) and the setting up of SITE was obviously helping ISRO to take off too. Another important individual who contributed to the success of SITE was the Director of Space Applications Centre in Allahabad, Professor Yashpal. He was instrumental in getting ISRO the rights to producing programmes for SITE whereas the administrative rights was still with All India Radio (AIR). He further argued for the continuation of ISRO's involvement in educational programming after the SITE experiment ended. Even the extensive evaluation of the programmes was done under the aegis of the Development and Educational Communication Unit (DECU) of ISRO.

The third and the most important person in this whole activity was none other than Indira Gandhi, the then Prime Minister of India, who was in fact going through a very rough patch at that time in her political career. As author and social scientist, Bela Mody commented, "The most decisive reason was the demonstration of the political advantages of the government controlled communication system that reached villagers in the remotest corners of the country with the official line from the party in power. The daily satellite news programme gave the then beleaguered prime minister...instantaneous monopoly access to voters."

It was also a safe mode of introducing the new medium which took 23 years to reach India and even after that it remained mostly confined to the metros or other such urban spaces. Because those who had an interest in the expansion of the industry also realised that educational experiments would be the least risky introduction to the new industry.

It has been pointed out by critics that the beneficiaries of SITE included indigenous manufacturers of satellite equipment, their foreign counterparts that included NASA, Ford Aerospace, General Electric, Hughes Aircraft, Massachusetts Institute of Technology and not to forget 'the members of the international community who were interested to have a general case study of educational broadcasting by satellite.

There was one offshoot of the SITE project, the KHEDA project conducted in the Kheda district of Gujarat, which was experimenting in participatory programme making in a small village on their local and often 'controversial' issues. It started in 1975 and even won the UNESCO prize in rural communication in 1984. But in 1985 the transmitter was dismantled and sent to Chennai for starting an entertainment channel. According to P.C. Joshi, "The Kheda Project...was wound up under tremendous pressure of the new rural middle class which was carried away by the glitter and glamour of the new television software..."

During the internal emergency of 1975-77 a strict regulation was imposed on the functioning of all forms of media; the state controlled media, being the first and most serious victim. As soon as the Janata Party Government came to power, they had constituted a commission chaired by a retired Chief Justice of the Supreme Court J.C. Shah, to investigate the excesses committed during the Emergency and the government brought out a white paper on the issue. It was submitted in August 1977 and immediately a working group headed by the former

newspaper editor B. G. Verghese was constituted to look into the issue of autonomy of Doordarshan (DD) and All India Radio (AIR) both state controlled media apparatus.

The Committee proposed the formation of a trust which it called Akash Bharati. The bill was introduced in the Parliament immediately but lapsed after the dissolution of the Lok Sabha in 1979 when the Janata party led Government fell. Mrs.

Gandhi returned to power in 1980 and her government decided not to back this Bill because, according to the report for 1979 to 1980 of the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MI&B), “such an organization is not considered necessary to enable those mass media to discharge their basic objective of serving people who are not served by other media” (MIB Report 1979-80).

In July 1980 the MI&B issued policy guidelines for the official media and placed before both houses of Parliament. In November, the Government constituted an advisory committee headed by G. Parthasarathi and it submitted a document called *News Policy for Broadcast Media*, which was issued by the government in May 1982. Interestingly these guidelines instruct the news gathering apparatus to “make a deliberate effort to explore new areas of development and nation-building news” (MI&B report 1982). And it stresses that “in a developing country the special function of broadcasting should be the coverage of development, its significance, achievements and problems.”

Again in December 1982 the Government appointed a Working Group (WG) on Software for DD with the objective of preparing “a software plan for DD taking into consideration the main objectives of television of assisting in the process of social and economic development in the country and to act as an effective medium for providing information, education and entertainment.” (WG report)

During the days of Indira Gandhi, the infrastructure for television communication received a major boost. The major trigger was the phenomenal popular transmission of the 1982 Asiad Games which was hosted by India. S.S. Gill, an officer of the Indian Administrative Service who was involved in creation of stadia, roads and other infrastructure for the Asian Games, was appointed Secretary of Ministry of Information and Broadcasting with the express purpose of creating an all India structure of television network within a short span of time. Beginning July 1983, an 18-month project to expand the network was sanctioned by the government, with a budget allocation of Rs 680 million.

However it was not designed to increase the diversity of programming available, but rather to increase the reach of programming that originated in Delhi. All the stations in the entire country were required to uplink programme broadcast by Delhi centre from 8.30 to 11pm. As most of the programmes were in Hindi, it created problems as it was seen as an imposition on the other regions by New Delhi.

After the assassination of Mrs. Gandhi (31st of October 1984), Rajiv Gandhi became the Prime Minister of India riding on the sympathy vote, while Doordarshan lured the voters with the constant visuals of the mourning masses. At that time the state controlled media had the traditional regulation of mourning for seven days in continuation in case of demise of the head of the state, which was subsequently changed in the late 1990s.

After Rajiv Gandhi became the Prime Minister, he called for greater independence for Doordarshan. Between the years 1984-85 over 120 television transmitters were installed in India. Bhaskar Ghose along with the support of Minister of Information and Broadcasting V.N. Gadgil went for total upheaval of the programming pattern. However Gadgil had succumbed to the political pressure when he was asked to resign in 1986 during a cabinet reshuffling. In 1987, Bofors arm scandal rocked the nation and Rajiv Gandhi had to face the heat. In fact his entire duration was full of troubles, the Bhopal Gas Tragedy happened only two months after he became the Prime Minister, his Sri Lanka policy was highly criticised. However by April 1988, Doordarshan had already begun to air documentaries on sensitive issues like Bofors arms kickback controversy, Gorkhaland agitation, Sati (sparked by the death of Roop Kanwar in September 1987) etc. In October Ghose was transferred out from Doordarshan.

The ruling party decided to go for a damage control drive with the help of Doordarshan. In April 1989, Mr. K. K. Tewary was appointed Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting. After this, use of media as an election strategy became blatantly heavy handed. But not all the states followed the dictates, mainly those ruled by the non Congress government. The left front government banned the entry of the Doordarshan camera men into the government functions. The print media too led by *The Indian Express* led a campaign against such brazen use of Doordarshan.

All these did not really translate into win for the ruling party. The Congress got 137 seats and emerged as the single largest party but did not form the government. The V.P. Singh led a coalition government which was short lived and conflict driven from the very beginning. However Doordarshan was asked to be more objective and stop broadcasting news of the ruling party leaders alone. The first move of the government was to propose the Prasar Bharati Bill aiming at granting autonomy to the electronic media in 1989. It sparked nationwide debate and deliberation. However despite the repeated assurances by V.P. Singh and Minister of Information and Broadcasting P. Upendra, by July 1990 it became clear that the bill will not be enacted.

Slowly the initial euphoria of change died down and Doordarshan went back to its role as propagandist. P. Upendra's interview to the press in fact summarised the mood:

I admit that Doordarshan is not autonomous today...Frankly, they're not ready for autonomy- they are conditioned to being dictated to at every stage, they're not used to using their own judgement. They don't know how far they can go. They're confused and it shows (Times of India, 1990: 3)

This in fact echoed the sentiment of Rajiv Gandhi when he was asked in The Press Club of America in 1985 about his plans of giving autonomy to the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. He answered: "At the moment none... We feel India is not ready for it yet".

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. Write short notes on:

Site

1. Kheda TV

2. Verghese Committee

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2. Write briefly on Doordarshan during the days of Rajiv Gandhi.

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13.4 TELEVISION AFTER GULF WAR

The glorious monopoly of Doordarshan came to an end when Star TV based in Hong Kong started beaming programmes into India via ASIASEAT-1 satellite in May 1991. In fact satellite television came to India as an agent of global capitalism. Cable Television made a stealth inroad into the Indian homes of the middle class who are the natural and major consumer of television. This development coincided with the Indian government accelerating its process of economic liberalisation. As if in keeping with the new thinking, the government did not try to restrict or ban the reception of foreign channels. Some critics were of the view that the initial response of the government to the illegal transmission and distribution of cross-border television channels was one of tolerance rather than of resistance. The Congress party, which had ushered in a new economic policy of liberalisation, did not wish to give the impression that it wanted in any way to restrict or block the transnational television channels.

It has been observed by some that cable television in India grew in the absence of a cohesive communication policy and can be called a sheer entrepreneurial genius. It is an exemplar of entrepreneurial initiative leading and outrunning government policy. Almost as a knee jerk reaction, the Government constituted a committee for an assessment of the consequences of introducing competition in the electronic media.

Simultaneously the Ministry was also deliberating on opening up the airwaves to the private players and so in September 1992 another committee was constituted

to look into the matter. The committee was specifically asked to work out the modus operandi to give licences to private producers to produce programmes for the second channel of Doordarshan as well as on FM radio channels. This was a drastic policy change as the Government was warming up to the idea of inculcating private players to their fold with not much censor. The airwaves were opened up and then came the deluge in India's broadcasting reforms. In 1995 the move to promulgate an ordinance regulating cable television was made, and the following year a cable law with certain provisions of regulating the content broadcast were introduced and passed. It was enforced throughout the country but never implemented.

13.4.1 Star and Zee Television

Hong Kong based STAR (Satellite Television Asian Region) entered into an agreement with an Indian company and Zee TV was born. It became the first privately owned Hindi satellite channel of India. The agreement between STAR and Zee did not last long. But the Indian television audience was waiting for a shift from the monopoly of Doordarshan and soon a number of private channels emerged.

The private channel business was not popular amongst the Indian business men immediately. It was only Subhash Chandra who started Hindi Zee TV and Sashi Kumar who started the first indigenous channel in Malayalam, Asianet. Subhash Chandra raised huge resources from a British Businessman Sir James Goldsmith and also from Indians living abroad and signed a deal with Star on 25th April 1992 and the new channel, Zee TV which started broadcasting from October the same year.

Similarly Asianet also ran into rough weather as far as finance is concerned. India still had legal and technical restraints on private broadcasting. Therefore Asianet had to set up its base in Russia. However the Kerala government helped Sashi Kumar in using the Kerala State Electricity Board poles to be used by Asianet for ten years. Slowly the fortune for Asianet too began to change.

Media mogul Rupert Murdoch bought 64% stakes in the Hutch Vision Limited, the supplier of programmes to star TV for \$525 million in July 1993. Subhas Chandra rejected Murdoch's overtures and resulted in a long battle and went on till 1999 when he bought back all the stakes of Murdoch in Zee for \$300 million.

Star TV became popular primarily due to two reasons: the Gulf War live coverage of CNN and because it became possible to directly download the signals as satellites dishes grew in numbers. The reaction of the India government was to immediately launch satellite channels of its own under the umbrella of Doordarshan. The government also tried to offer its satellite platforms to global companies like CNN, which of course was short lived when CNN found a transponder of its own.

In 1995 itself Sengupta Committee was constituted to look into the almost forgotten Prasar Bharati Bill of 1990 and it rang the bell on allowing privatisation of both radio and television. STAR TV again became the force behind jostling the government from its slumber, when they declared their plan to launch DTH (Direct- to-home) services in India. This led to the meeting of the Committee of Secretaries of various Departments under the aegis of the Cabinet Secretary in January 1997.

In July 1997, the Ministry of Communications issued a notification prohibiting the use of broadcast apparatus for the transmitting or receiving of signals in frequency bands above 4800 MHz. And the explanation given was that DTH “would enable any broadcaster within or outside India to telecast or beam any programme of his choice directly to the houses and bedrooms of the general public” (Ministry of Communication Notification, 1997, Reprinted in Gazette of India Extraordinary, July 16, 1997, at 4.) Murdoch’s STAR TV went to the court, invoking the freedom of speech in Article 19 (1) of the Indian Constitution.

The change of guard in the United Front Government and a new Minister in MI&B resulted in the notification of the Prasar Bharati Bill in July 1997. Though the issue of autonomy was already diluted even before the notification, but the sheer exercise of notifying the bill did amount to a statement of purpose. A number of changes were later incorporated like the scrapping of the parliamentary committee, transferring the asset of AIR and DD on lease, reduction of number of government officials to one etc. On September 15, 1997, the notification came into force, finally bringing Prasar Bharati into existence. Parliament met in November 1997, but the Lok Sabha ended up getting dissolved. Before the Fresh elections were declared the bill was ratified so that the board can continue till the formation of the new government. However even that move had not been able to ensure autonomy to AIR and DD. In fact in 2011, all the Prasar Bharati employees have been again designated as government employees and CEO was caught in a case of corruption.

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) issued a Consultation Paper (No. 13/2008) on Media Ownership on 23rd September 2008, wherein it was stated, ‘.... the issues of cross media restrictions are to be addressed in an inclusive manner covering broadcasting services, print media and other miscellaneous ownership within the fold of telecom, information and broadcasting’ (pg.2). The consultation paper refers to three types of restrictions—cross media ownership across electronic and print media, vertical integration within particular media segments and market-share based restrictions. But reality is far removed.

13.4.2 24 × 7 News

India got her first private 24-hour news channel in 1998 and by 2007 it grew to 300 television channels of all genre combined. The precursor of ‘live news’ was news programme called *News Tonight*, privately produced by NDTV owned by Prannoy Roy and Radhika Roy broadcast through Doordarshan every night. The then Director General of Doordarshan, Rathikant Basu was the one who brought the new idea.

When Rathikant Basu was hired as Star’s head of operations, it opened the doors for NDTV. It got a prime-time slot for half-an-hour news bulletin on two Star channels— Star Plus and Star—World. In 1998 the historical decision of Star and NDTV to start India’s first 24-hour news channel called the Star News coincided with the 1998 general elections. When NDTV’s five year contract ended with Star in 2003, it went to set up its own channel NDTV 24X7. That was the beginning of the 24X7 news channels.

13.4.3 Regional Television

Yet another important development in the last few years is the impressive growth of Regional language Television Channels which cater to the regional eye balls

as well as those people from the region who are scattered around the country and many-a-times even to the diaspora.

The growth of these regional news channels of 24x7 format with either political leaders or business conglomerates owning most of them, is now the trend in the contemporary history of Indian television. Cross media ownership and foreign direct investment has changed the entire political economy of television sector.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. Describe how private TV channels entered India.

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2. Do you think regional television is good for the health of democracy?

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13.5 LOOKING AT THE FUTURE

The growth of the news channels of 24x7 format with either political leader or business conglomerates owning most of them, is now the trend in the contemporary history of Indian television. Cross media ownership and foreign direct investment has changed the entire political economy of television sector. The future is full of anticipation and apprehension as we need to remember that this entire growth story has been chartered in the background of media policy vacuum. The latest debates had been on paid news and regulation, and it will be interesting to observe which way it pans out.

13.6 LET US SUM UP

We hope by now you have an idea about the growth trajectory of television in India as well as that of the International scenario. From a reluctant governmental approach to a sudden spurt in 1990s, television has now become the dominant medium in India. However the Public Service broadcaster has not fared so well in this hullabaloo. It is still under the governmental control but with a very impressive all India presence. While the private channels are here to stay, a serious revamping of Doordarshan needs to be undertaken. A country which is lagging

behind in so many social parameters needs a responsible Public Service broadcaster doubt.

TV

13.7 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READINGS

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13.8 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

Refer 13.2

Check Your Progress 2

Refer 13.3.2

Check Your Progress 3

Refer 13.4

UNIT 14 TECHNOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENTS IN COMMUNICATION

Structure

- 14.0 Introduction
- 14.1 Learning Outcomes
- 14.2 Technological Developments in Communication
- 14.3 Printing Revolution
- 14.4 Visual Revolution
 - 14.4.1 Photography
 - 14.4.2 Flexible Roll Film
 - 14.4.3 Cinema
- 14.5 Electronic Revolution
 - 14.5.1 Telegraph and Telephone
 - 14.5.2 Radio
 - 14.5.3 Television
- 14.6 Digital Revolution
 - 14.6.1 Web 1.0
 - 14.6.2 Web 2.0
 - 14.6.3 Web 3.0
- 14.7 Let Us Sum Up
- 14.8 References and Further Readings
- 14.9 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

14.0 INTRODUCTION

We are living in the information age in which information has become a commodity that is quickly and widely disseminated. We are surrounded by innumerable messages originating from wide variety of media and sources of information such as Newspapers, Magazines, TV, Radio, Books and Online media providing a variety of information. The messages are also in varied forms of text, audio, video, graphics, interactive stories, infographics; satiating the information needs of the people who prefer to consume media messages in different ways. This wide variety of media forms which we witness today is the result of continuous technological revolutions which are happening in the field of communication. Four major developments have taken place in the past which we can term as revolution in communication as with each revolution a new medium emerged offering new and improved ways of constructing as well as disseminating messages.

In this unit, we shall discuss the technological revolutions that have taken place in the field of communication which have resulted in the emergence of a medium. From Printing to Digital the entire journey will be traced, as the evolution of each medium is the result of some technological development. Since we are

living in digital era, greater focus shall be placed on the emergence of online media and its impact on society.

14.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After studying this unit, you should be able to:

- describe major technological revolutions that have taken place since 1430s; and
- link each technological revolution with the emergence of a specific medium such as print, radio, television and digital media.

14.2 TECHNOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENTS IN COMMUNICATION

The technological revolutions in Media and Communication have influenced the media industry as well as society as a whole and changed the way we consume media messages. A huge difference can be seen in the way our parents and grandparents used to consume media messages as compared to us. Till a few years back, listening to radio or watching television, used to be a social activity. When Radio and TV were at nascent stage, the privileged few owned radio and television sets. People used to get together at someone's place to watch or listen to popular programmes such as Humlog (1984), Ramayana (1986), Buniyad (1986) and Mahabharata (1988) as a form of community viewing.

When TV and Radio became part of individual houses the community viewing was replaced by family viewing. As soon as television entered the home, it acquired a central place in the architecture of the home and in the organisation of daily life (Lotz, 2009). Programmes on Radio and TV became gathering point for families. Debates, discussion and gossips after watching a programme was one of the endearing family activity. This collective activity in some households gradually became isolated and individualised primarily because of the availability of more than one TV and Radio sets in a household and also because of the availability of more channels and programmes. This meant watching or listening to the programmes of one's own interest rather than 'collectively selected' one programme that suited the entertainment or information needs of all the family members, regardless of their age and interests. Now one could surf channels and tune in to different frequencies to watch or listen to their favourite programme. This trend amplified with the emergence of multiple screens especially with the advent of hand held screens in the form of smart phones.

Availability of the internet enabled phones and laptops not only means every individual has access to the medium but it also means that they have access to every medium; as on internet every medium is integrated. This led to the emergence of another trend - Media hopping. The reason for this trend is the availability of various media formats on one device and also people's need to consume media messages differently. Many of us these days, in the process of obtaining information and for entertainment, move from one medium to another. This movement from one medium to another in search of relevant and good content is termed as 'media hopping'. The concept is similar to channel surfing which is also known as, 'channel hopping' and 'channel zapping'. This term, however, is associated with television or radio. As viewers have hundreds of TV

channels or radio frequencies, they scan them quickly and frequently to find something interesting. While in 'media surfing' the movement is within the medium, in media hopping the movement is complex as it is from one medium to another and also from one content to another within a specific medium.

In his book *Revolutions in Communication: Media History from Gutenberg to the Digital Age*, veteran journalist, teacher and historian Bill Kovaricka, explored four major epochs of the mass media history through the technologies that characterised their development - printing, imaging, broadcasting and digital media. According to him, the historical narrative of media revolves around technological changes - a common thread that unites global media history.

Let us trace the technological revolution taken place in the field of communication and how it has impacted the way we consume, create and disseminate media messages.

14.3 PRINTING REVOLUTION

"He who first shortened the labor of copyists by device of movable types was disbanding hired armies, and cashiering most kings and senates, and creating a whole new democratic world: he had invented the art of printing" (Thomas Carlyle, *Sartor Resartus*, 1833).

Johannes Guttenberg by introducing the mechanical movable type printing to the world in 1439 laid the foundation for the knowledge based economy. This first technological revolution in the field of communication i.e. the Printing revolution democratised the process of knowledge generation as well as consumption. Spread of learning to the masses was made possible by this most important technological revolution in the field of communication. The invention of printing had a huge impact on the lives of the people of Europe initially and then eventually the entire world. Until the invention of printing, only a few had control over knowledge. The Monks used to write books which used to take years to complete, hence the books available were very expensive and out of the reach of common people.

Printing Revolution was the result of growing expectations of Renaissance, cultural and intellectual movements that spanned from 14th to 16th century in Europe. Acting as a catalyst for the Renaissance, printing facilitated it to spread as it enabled new ideas to reach larger audience. Printing removed the barriers to communication that existed in medieval society and contributed to dialogue and debate that was the essence of Renaissance.

"Although few had books before John Gutenberg gave us our art, not until printing could come learning, yes and wisdom also, knocking at every man's door". (Latin of Cardelius, 1546).

Printing was not new and most of the technologies involved in printing were already known and being employed in various ways when the printing revolution took place in the 1450s.

"Stamps in soft clay had been used as part of the ancient Babylonian accounting system, and metal seals were often impressed into wax to validate official documents in classical Rome. Wood block printing was widely used in China

from the sixth century onward for sacred Buddhist scrolls. Impressions on textiles were known in Europe as early as the 1100s, and the first known woodcuts on paper appeared in Europe around 1400 (Hind, 1963). Presses had been used on farms for centuries to make olive oil and to press grapes into wine” (History of Revolutions).

Thus Gutenberg invented a technology that resulted in Printing Revolution by adapting existing technologies. He used multiple processes like the making impressions, presses, ink which existed earlier and combined them to develop hand-moulded metal printing matrices, and produced a movable type-based printing press system.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1. What does the term ‘Media hopping’ mean? How is it different from channel surfing/channel hopping?

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2. What impact printing revolution had on Renaissance?

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14.4 VISUAL REVOLUTION

Printing revolution was followed by Visual revolution. While visuals existed before the invention of photography but they were the result of wood art printing, engraving, and etching lithography. What impressed the world was images of real life, the way we see with our eyes, which were more accurate than paintings and as British Library explains, ‘allowed members of the public to feel they were viewing these people in the flesh.’

14.4.1 Photography

Photography is a combination of two Greek words “photos” (light) and “graphe” in (to draw). The word was first used by the scientist Sir John F.W. Herschel in 1839. It is a method of recording images by the action of light, or related radiation, on a sensitive material. Joseph Nicéphore Niépce made the first photographic image with a camera obscura in 1827. Joseph Nicéphore Niépce’s heliographs

or sun prints as they were called were the prototype for the modern photograph, by letting light draw the picture. Since 1827, many developments took place and a number of people contributed to the art of photography, as we see today. Following is the list of some major technological development in the field of photography

Daguerreotype Method: The process that created lasting image was developed by Louis Daguerre in 1839.

Negative to Positive Process: The inventor of the first negative from which multiple positive prints were made was Henry Fox Talbot, an English botanist and mathematician and a contemporary of Daguerre. In 1841, he perfected this paper-negative process and called it a “collotype”, Greek for beautiful picture.

Tintypes, patented in 1856 by Hamilton Smith, were another medium that heralded the birth of photography. A thin sheet of iron was used to provide a base for light-sensitive material, yielding a positive image.

Wet plate Negatives: In 1851, Frederick Scoff Archer, an English sculptor, invented the wet plate negative. Using a viscous solution of collusion, he coated glass with light-sensitive silver salts. Because it was glass and not paper, this wet plate created a more stable and detailed negative.

Dry Plate Negatives and hand held Cameras: In 1879, the dry plate was invented, a glass negative plate with a dried gelatin emulsion. Dry plates could be stored for a period of time. Photographers no longer needed portable darkrooms and could now hire technicians to develop their photographs. Dry processes absorbed light quickly so rapidly that the hand-held camera was now possible.

14.4.2 Flexible Roll Film

In 1889, George Eastman invented film with a base that was flexible, unbreakable, and could be rolled. Emulsions coated on a cellulose nitrate film base, such as Eastman's, made the mass-produced box camera a reality. Images have a lot of power and it is often said that a picture is worth a thousand words. A picture can document history, explain a process, visualise an abstract, depicts a story, capture nature and can speak a volume on relationships. The growing culture of ‘selfie’ has also made capturing self possible and it does not only reflect how that physical self has been beautifully captured but also reveals one's inner self.

Photographs have a huge impact on us as individuals and as a society. There have been many movements started in the past just because one photograph was so impactful that it stirred the conscience of people and motivated them to stand up and take action. There have been some photographs which appear time and gain due to the story behind them as well as their impact.

Activity 1

Search the web for the ‘most popular photographs or images’ and find the photographer and the story behind the photograph. Write the same in your own words.

Photographer

Story

The idea to work on motion picture camera came from the technology that was invented earlier. In October 1888 Thomas Edison, sometimes called the father of motion pictures, wrote, “I am experimenting upon an instrument which does for the Eye what the phonograph does for the Ear” Actually, “motion” pictures only seem to move. A modern movie camera takes still pictures like a regular camera does. However, it takes 24 of these pictures, or frames, per second. When you show these pictures at a very fast rate, they appear as if they are moving. Auguste Lumiere and Louis Jean – known as Lumi re Brothers were the first filmmakers in the history. They invented motion-picture camera and projector called the Cinema to graphe and patented the same in 1895. “Cinema” is derived from this name. It was an improved version of what Thomas Edison invented as it allowed simultaneous viewing by multiple parties. Even Lumeire Brothers did not know that cinema will be such a flourishing business one day as Auguste Lumiere said, “My invention (the motion picture camera), can be exploited... as a scientific curiosity, but apart from that it has no commercial value whatsoever”.

A number of technological developments took place in the last hundred years which made watching cinema a ‘pleasurable experience’. Indian Film industry too embraced technology advancements across its value chain. Today digital technologies are used extensively in production, marketing and distribution. Since people prefer to watch movies on digital platforms, many filmmakers are exploring the option of releasing their movies on digital platforms at the same time when it is released in theatres. The filmmakers are considering different models for distribution like Subscription Video on Demand which allows the audience to access a wide range of content by paying subscription fees or offering them an option of off line VOD, which can be the future of viewing content. This is an additional feature that allows end users to watch high quality HD video content even when they are not connected to the internet.

Digital offers many opportunities in production, distribution and marketing, but it also offers challenges - the biggest one is piracy. Cam-cording is one of the common ways of piracy where people illegally record movies and upload it on web or make DVDs. Such content is released within the day of the release of a movie. There is a need for increased cooperation between the government and industry to tackle this problem of piracy.

In recent years the Netflix model is offering a new alternative of watching cinema by online streaming of a library of films and television programmes, including those produced in-house. A subscription-based OTT (Over The Top) service directly reaching viewers over the Internet, circumvents traditional cinema and broadcast television platforms that control or are distributors of such content.

Many changes have occurred in the ways films are produced, marketed and distributed because of technological advancements but one thing that remains unchanged is its impact on society. It works in both the directions. It reflects what is happening in the society and at the same time it has a potential to influence people with its content.

Activity 2		
Mention the major societal problems discussed in the following Indian movies:		
S.No.	Name of the film	Major problem
1)	Peepli Live	
2)	Achhoot Kanya	
3)	Mother India	
4)	Roza	
5)	Manthan	
6)	No One Killed Jessica	
7)	Zanjeer	

14.5 ELECTRONIC REVOLUTION

Three major developments took place as part of the Electronic Revolution; these were the invention of Telegraph and telephone; Radio and Television.

The need to transmit messages at a fast speed was felt by many people. There have been many instances where the delay in sending and receiving messages caused problems. One such example was the delay in news of peace treaty signed by the United States and Britain to the Armies. When the United States and Britain fought the battle on January 8, 1815, the armies in the field could not have known that a peace treaty had been signed before Christmas of 1814. It took seven weeks for the fastest sailboat to carry the message from London to Louisiana resulting in loss of lives on both sides. Telegraph and telephone solved this problem.

14.5.1 Telegraph and Telephone

Telegraph and telephone are usually considered one-to-one communications devices, both also have an important place in the mass media. Major newspapers in 19th and 20th centuries were linked by telegraph. Telephone system (based on radio signals) also played a key role in establishing centralised broadcasting system.

Telegraph system was developed in the 1830s and 1840s by Samuel Morse (1791-1872) and other inventors. In this system, electrical signals were transmitted over a wire laid between stations. Morse said, “this mode of instantaneous communication must inevitably become an instrument of immense power, to be wielded for good or for evil” (Samuel Morse, 1838). Alexander Graham Bell was awarded the first U.S. patent for the invention of telephone in 1876. Telegraph was one-to-one text based communication; telephone was one-to-one voice based communication. Both Telegraph and Telephone revolutionised long-distance communication.

14.5.2 Radio

“Dissatisfaction with the old technology paved the way for the emergence of new technology”. Solar flares of 1859 sparked the interest in electromagnetic spectrum.

“The Solar storm of 1859 - known as the Carrington Event - was a powerful geomagnetic solar storm during solar cycle 10 (1855–1867). Telegraph systems worldwide went haywire. Spark discharges shocked telegraph operators and set the telegraph paper on fire. Even when telegraphers disconnected the batteries powering the lines, aurora-induced electric currents in the wires still allowed messages to be transmitted” (NASA).

The damage caused to the entire telegraph system due to the solar fires, made many to think about wireless telegraphy. Wireless telegraphy and broadcasting was not the invention of one but it was made possible by a combination of discoveries by scientists from different countries. Though many people contributed to the invention of Radio including Nikolai Tesla who demonstrated a wireless radio in St. Louis, Missouri in 1893; it was Guglielmo Marconi who is often credited as the father and inventor of the radio and for this reason he was given the first wireless telegraphy patent in 1896 in England.

It was the transmission of signals on Dec 12, 1901 across the Atlantic Ocean that earned him a very respectable position in history. So powerful was the medium that at one point of time it created mass panic in America. “The War of the Worlds” aired over the Columbia Broadcasting System on Sunday, October 30, 1938 created mass panic as it suggested alien invasion by Martians. The episode was adaptation of H.G. Wells’ novel - The War of the Worlds which of course was a drama, but the way it was presented by filmmaker Orson Welles, people took it as a reality and there was a mass hysteria.

“Huge flaming object” had struck a farm near Grover’s Mill, New Jersey. A “newscaster” described seeing an alien crawl out of a spacecraft. “Good heavens—something’s wriggling out of the shadow,” he reported. “It glistens like wet leather. But that face—it ... it is indescribable.”

In India, this power of Radio has been exploited for behaviour change. One such example of using radio as a medium to bring about change in the behaviour of people was the 104 episode radio serial drama (1996-1997) produced by AIR in partnership with Population Communications International (PCI), Tinka Tinka Sukh. The programme received excellent feedback and the letters received from the audience showed the impact of radio medium.

The radio Industry has also grown manifold in India. The reach of All India Radio is 92 percent of the country’s area and 99.19 percent of the population. In addition to Public Service Broadcasting system comprising of AIR operating in the FM, AM and SW frequencies, there are private FM station running in 86 cities and there are more than 200 community radio stations.

Digital radio is the emerging trend. Keeping in view the increase in the internet penetration and growth of smartphone segments in India; traditional broadcasts radio channels have taken their stations online and there are companies that run internet based radio services.

14.5.3 Television

It is said that television was invented in 1926 but at that time it was not known as TV but was called ‘televisor’ or mechanical television. It was created by John Logie Baird, who is generally regarded as the father of television. TV as we see

today is the result of the experiments on two distinct technologies - first the attempts to build mechanical television system based on the rotating discs and second was to build an electronic TV using Cathode Ray Tube. Electronic television systems worked better and eventually replaced mechanical systems. Russian inventor, Vladimir Zworykin invented an improved cathode-ray tube called the kinescope in 1929. The kinescope tube was sorely needed for television. Zworykin was one of the first to demonstrate a television system with all the features of modern picture tubes.

In India, television broadcast started on 15th September 1959 as an experiment. There were only two one-hour programmes a week, each of one hour duration. Imagine a television set working for only two hours a week! All India Radio handled these initial broadcasts. The early programmes on these experimental broadcasts were generally educational programmes for school children and farmers. Several community television sets were set up in Delhi's rural areas and schools around Delhi for the dissemination of these programmes.

By the 1970s, television centers were set-up in other parts of the country. In 1976, Doordarshan, which was All India Radio's television arm until then; became a separate department. Several community television sets were distributed as a part of one of the important landmarks in the history of Indian television, the Satellite Instructional Television Experiment (SITE) was conducted between August 1975 and July 1976. Under this programme, the Indian government used the American satellite ATS-6 to broadcast educational programmes. Six states were selected for this experiment and television sets were distributed in these states. SITE was an important step taken by India to use television for development.

The programmes were mainly produced by Doordarshan which was then a part of AIR. The telecasts happened twice a day, in the morning and evening. Apart from agricultural information, health and family planning were the other important topics dealt with in these programmes. Entertainment was also included in the telecasts in the form of dance, music, drama, folk and rural art forms. From one programme a week to 24x7 programming and from one channel to hundreds of channel, TV industry has grown manifold since then.

With the increase in internet connectivity and availability of cheap smartphones, there is explosion of online videos. Anyone who has access to technology and internet enabled phone also has the opportunity to create and disseminate videos. One can also do something which was unheard of till a few years back, they can create their own channel. Depending on the interest, YouTube is full of channels on DIYs, politics, news, entertainment, travel, food etc. The reach of some of these channels is much more than that of a traditional TV channel. The last few years witnessed huge increase in the number of videos created and uploaded. In addition to internet connectivity and cheap smartphones, this was made possible by new digital tools that allow creating and editing videos on the go.

Most of the social networking websites such as Facebook, Snapchat, Twitter integrated these tools so that anyone create and disseminate these videos for the high percentage of the world population that is connected with internet. Some of the emerging trends we are witnessing now a days are immersive story telling (360 degree videos), video selfies etc.

Online news platforms such as The Quint roped in senior journalists during 2017 state elections (UP) for new media journalism and used selfie videos, Facebook live extensively to cover the elections. The New York Times also announced its launch on Snapchat discover forum to reach out to the youth population in the US who are using Snapchat extensively.

The examples of The Quint and The New York Times reveal how new technology is shaping the way media messages are constructed. TV no longer has the monopoly over videos, even online newspapers host videos on their portal.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

- a) Discuss an example where the delay in sending and receiving messages caused lot of problems.

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- b) Name the event that sparked the interest in electromagnetic spectrum.

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- c) Discuss the incident related to radio that caused mass panic in America in 1938.

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- d) TV is the result of the experiments on which technologies?

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14.6 DIGITAL REVOLUTION

According to International Telecommunication Union, the rapid growth of Information and Communication Technologies and innovation in digital systems represent a revolution that has fundamentally changed the way people think, behave, communicate, work and earn their livelihood. This so-called digital revolution has forged new ways to create knowledge, educate people and disseminate information. It has restructured the way the world conducts economic and business practices, runs governments and engages politically. It has provided for the speedy delivery of humanitarian aid and healthcare, and a new vision for environmental protection. It has even created new avenues for entertainment and leisure. As access to information and knowledge is a prerequisite to achieving the Sustainable Development Goals or SDGs – it has the capacity to improve living standards for millions of people around the world. Moreover, better communication between people helps resolve conflicts and attain world peace.

Two technological factors that led to the digital revolution are personal computer and the Internet. This technological revolution began in the 1960s when the foundation for modern internet was laid by the Department of Defense through its ARPANET programme.

The first personal computers were introduced in the early 1970s. A number of technological innovations happened in the past and are still taking place and shaping the Digital world every day. Each innovation triggered another and continuous developments are emerging in the field of Information and communication technologies.

To understand how web evolved over the years, it has been divided in to three versions Web 1.0, Web 2.0 and Web 3.0.

14.6.1 Web 1.0

The development of one technology inspires the development of others. Tim Berners –Lee the creator of Web 1.0 the first generation of web said, *“I made some electronic gadgets to control the trains. Then I ended up getting more interested in electronics than trains. Later on, when I was in college I made a computer out of an old television set.”*

According to him, Web 1.0 was the read only web as it allowed people to search for information and read - interaction and creation of content was not possible for the users. The purpose was to develop websites so that the information can be disseminated more on line with any other mass media.

The purpose for creating web was to share information. According to him *“In those days, there was different information on different computers, but you had to log on to different computers to get at it. Also, sometimes you had to learn a different program on each computer. Often it was just easier to go and ask people when they were having coffee....”*

According to him this could have been solved by exploiting hypertext technology. He in 1989 submitted a proposal “Information Management: A Proposal” to his boss at CERN, Mike Sendall, who did not accept the proposal initially and wrote, “vague but exciting”. Eventually Tim was given time to work on this project in September 1990.

By 1990, Tim had written the three fundamental technologies that remain the foundation of today's Web

HTML: Hyper Text Mark-up Language. The mark-up (formatting) language for the Web.

URI: Uniform Resource Identifier. A kind of "address" that is unique and used to identify to each resource on the Web. It is also commonly called a URL.

HTTP: Hypertext Transfer Protocol. Allows for the retrieval of linked resources from across the Web.

By the end of 1990, the first Web page was made available on the open Internet and in 1991, public was invited to join this new Web community.

14.6.2 Web 2.0

As the Web began to grow, Tim realised that its true potential would only be unleashed if anyone, anywhere could use it without paying a fee or having to ask for permission.

He explains: "Had the technology been proprietary, and in my total control, it would probably not have taken off. You can't propose that something be a universal space and at the same time keep control of it."

So, Tim and others advocated to ensure that CERN would agree to make the underlying code available on a royalty-free basis, for ever. This decision was announced in April 1993, and sparked a global wave of creativity, collaboration and innovation never seen before. These innovations led to the development of Web 2.0.

The term "Web 2.0" was first used in January 1999 by Darcy DiNucci, an information architecture consultant. In her article, "Fragmented Future", DiNucci writes:

"The Web we know now, which loads into a browser window in essentially static screenfuls, is only an embryo of the Web to come. The first glimmerings of Web 2.0 are beginning to appear, and we are just starting to see how that embryo might develop. The Web will be understood not as screenfuls of text and graphics but as a transport mechanism, the ether through which interactivity happens. It will appear on your computer screen, on your TV set, on your car dashboard, on your cell phone, on hand-held game machines and maybe even your microwave oven."

The term was popularised by Tim O'Reilly and Dale Dougherty at the O'Reilly Media Web 2.0 Conference in late 2004. A Web 2.0 website may allow users to interact and collaborate with each other in a social media dialogue as creators of user-generated content in a virtual community, in contrast to the first generation of Web 1.0 era websites where people were limited to the passive viewing of content. In contrast to Web 1.0 era websites, in which the text was often unlinked, users of Web 2.0 websites can often "click" on words in the text to access additional content on the website or be linked to an external website. Examples of Web 2.0 include social networking sites and social media sites. Whether Web 2.0 is substantively different from prior Web technologies has been challenged by World Wide Web inventor Tim Berners-Lee, who describes the term as jargon.

His original vision of the Web was “a collaborative medium, a place where we [could] all meet and read and write”.

14.6.3 Web 3.0

Web 3.0, many believe is the era of personalisation. The computer will remember and keep record of your previous searches and will offer you the results that are personalised for you. It is an extension of the 2.0 and has a lot of the qualities. However, this Web is where you do not do the work; the computer does it for you. The Web is going to simplify your search for you. This third generation of web is also called semantic web.

“I have a dream for the Web [in which computers] become capable of analysing all the data on the Web – the content, links, and transactions between people and computers. A “Semantic Web”, which makes this possible, has yet to emerge, but when it does, the day-to-day mechanisms of trade, bureaucracy and our daily lives will be handled by machines talking to machines. The “intelligent agents” people have touted for ages will finally materialise”. (Tim Berners Lee)

The basic idea of Web 3.0 is to define structure data and link them in order to more effective discovery, automation, integration, and reuse across various applications.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

Fill in the blanks

- 1) Two technological factors that lead to the digital revolution were and
- 2) The foundation for modern internet was laid by
- 3) According to Tim Berners Lee Web 1.0 was the web.
- 4) The three fundamental technologies written by Tim Berners Lee that remain the foundation of today's Web are, and
- 5) The term “Web 2.0” was first used by in her article.....
- 6) Web 3.0 is also called

14.7 LET US SUM UP

Technological revolution is a continuous process and one innovation leads to another. Similarly, the invention of one technology leads to the invention of another and there is no single person responsible for one invention; it is the result of hard work and continuous efforts of many. The emergence of Print, Television, Radio and New Media is the result of a series of technological developments. These technological developments resulted from the knowledge and experience acquired on working on a particular technology and also from the need for better and improved versions. Technological developments have huge impact on cultural, political and economic aspects in the society. Karl Marx explained this with the example of how a feudal society that used a hand mill

slowly changed into an industrial capitalist society with the introduction of the steam mill.

Technology according to “technological determinism’ defines its nature. The term was coined by Thorstein Veblen. According to him technology is the driving force of culture in a society and it determines its course of history. Hence to understand society, it is important to understand technology and technological developments that are taking place and that had happened in the past.

14.8 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READINGS

Bill Kovarick, *Revolutions in Communication: Media History from Gutenberg to the Digital Age*

Michael M.A. Mirabi to Barbara L. Morgenstern, *The New Communication Technologies; Applications, Policy, and Impact*, Focal Press (2004)

John Vince and Rae Earnshaw, *Digital Convergence: The Information Revolution*, Springer (1999)

Eric Schmidt and Jared Cohen, *The New Digital age, Reshaping the future of people, nations and Business*, John Murray (2013)

14.9 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1. The movement of individuals from one medium to another in search of relevant and good content is termed as Media hopping. The concept is similar to channel surfing or channel hopping/channel zapping associated with television or Radio in which the movement is within the medium. In media hopping the movement is from one medium to another and also from one content to another within a specific medium.
2. Renaissance was the cultural and intellectual movement that started in 14th century and lasted up to 16th century in Europe. Printing revolution acted as a catalyst for Renaissance as printing removed the barriers to communication that existed in medieval society and contributed to dialogue and debate that was the essence of Renaissance.

Check Your Progress 2

1. The delay in news of peace treaty signed by United States and Britain to the Armies. When the United States and Britain fought the battle on January 8, 1815, the armies in the field could not have known that a peace treaty had been signed before Christmas of 1814. It took seven weeks for the fastest sailboat to carry the message from London to Louisiana. This resulted in loss of lives on both sides.
2. Solar flares of 1859 sparked the interest in electromagnetic spectrum.
3. “The War of the Worlds” on Sunday, October 30, 1938 aired over the Columbia Broadcasting System created mass panic as it suggested alien

invasion by Martians. The episode was adaptation of H.G. wells' novel 'The War of the Worlds' which was a drama, but the way it was presented by filmmaker Orson Welles, people took it as a reality and there was mass hysteria.

4. TV as we see today is the result of the experiments on two distinct technologies - mechanical television system based on the rotating discs and electronic TV using Cathode Ray Tube.

Check Your Progress 3

1. Personal computer and the Internet
2. ARPANET
3. Read-only web
4. HTML, URL, HTTP
5. Darcy DiNucci in article Fragmented Future
6. Semantic Web



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